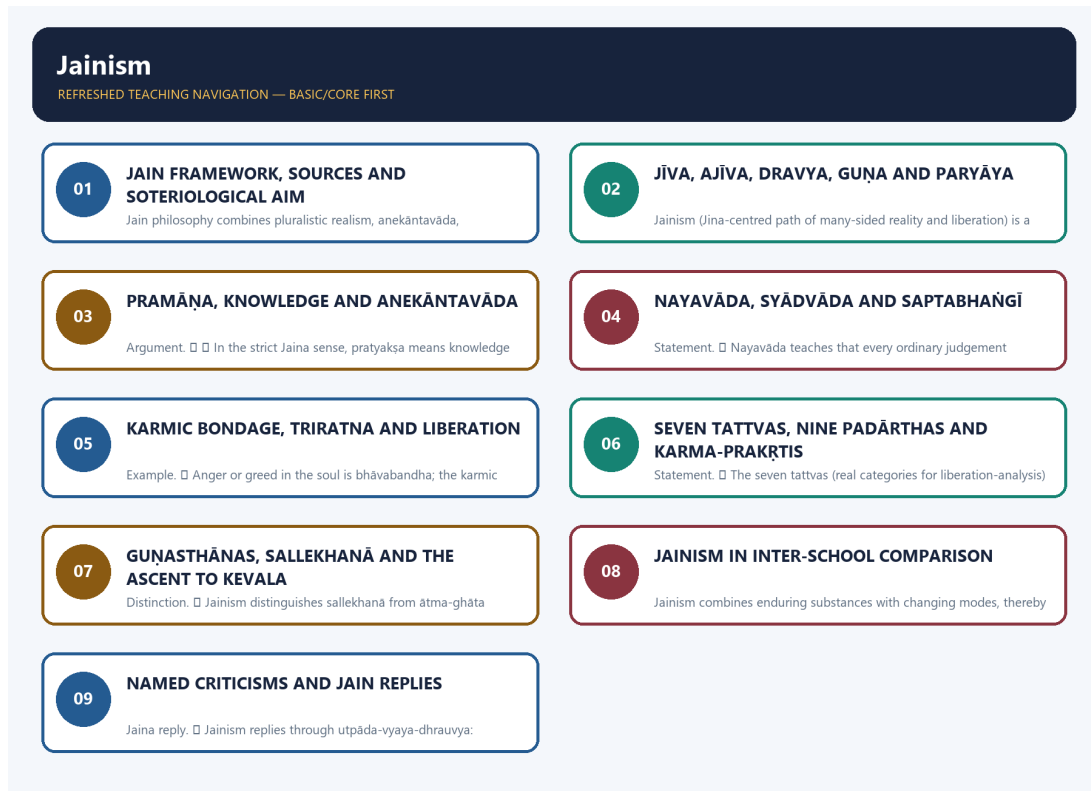


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Jainism - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Jainism - Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session	4
Package practice counts	4
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	4
Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels	5
SESSION 1 - JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM	5
SESSION 2 - JĪVA, AJĪVA, DRAVYA, GUṆA AND PARYĀYA	9
SESSION 3 - PRAMĀṆA, KNOWLEDGE AND ANEKĀNTAVĀDA	14
SESSION 4 - NAYAVĀDA, SYĀDVĀDA AND SAPTABHAṆGĪ	19
SESSION 5 - KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION	24
SESSION 6 - SEVEN TATTVAS, NINE PADĀRTHAS AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS	28
SESSION 7 - GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA	32
SESSION 8 - JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON	35
SESSION 9 - NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES	37
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	48
Practice protocol - [CORE ANSWER]	48
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	55
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	66
Layer-placement note	66
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	68
A. System identity	68
B. Reality	68
C. Substance and soul	68
D. Knowledge	69
E. Many-sided judgement	69
F. Sevenfold predication	69
G. Absolutism objection	69
H. Karma and bondage	69
I. Liberation sequence	69

J. Ethics and stages	70
K. Criticism-reply grid	70
L. Final answer discipline	70
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	70

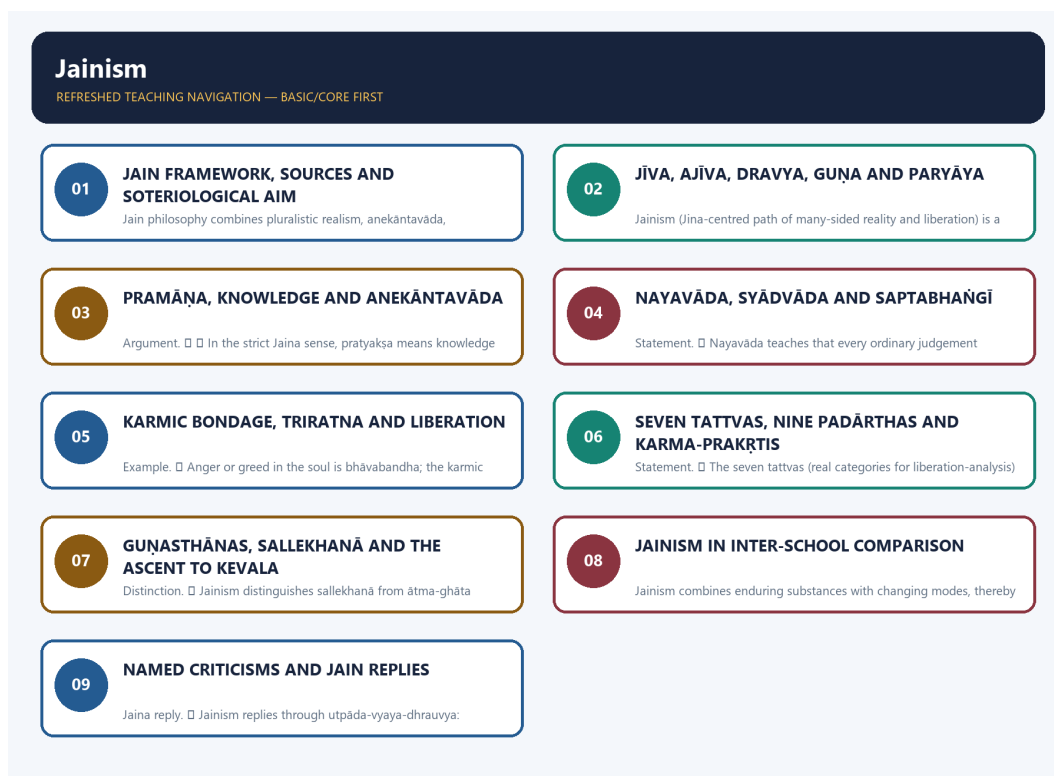
Jainism - Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

Catalogue identity: Philosophy Optional · Philosophy Paper I - Indian Philosophy · philosophy-paper-i-indian-philosophy-02 **Generation:** g2, 21 August 2026 · **Supersedes:** philosophy-paper-i-indian-philosophy-02: legacy-v1:g1 · **Approval:** pending explicit topic approval
Evidence discipline: doctrine and PYQ wording/year/marks are controlled by repository owners. Model answers are independent pedagogic practice, never official UPSC keys.

Package practice counts

Component	Count
Direct verified topic-owned PYQs	9
Core diagnostic MCQs	40
Remedial diagnostic MCQs	8
Total diagnostics	48
Original solved Mains models	6 (2 × 10, 2 × 15, 2 × 20)
Consolidated register parts	12 (A-L)
Approval	false

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

Source corpus	Final location	Retention decision
Layered Simple/Core/Exam/Rapid material	Basic Learning Session	Complete seven-subtopic teaching sequence retained
Layered Advanced material	Optional Advanced	Every advanced synthesis retained after practice
Canonical owner	Reconciled through layered session	Full metaphysics, epistemology, judgement and soteriology ownership retained
Legacy solved workbook	PYQs and Answer Practice	Nine solved PYQs preserved and improved
Premium diagnostic replacement	MCQs / Remediation	Legacy 24+8 set expanded to genuine 40+8 with strict rotation
Original practice	PYQs and Answer Practice	Six solved non-PYQ models replace the legacy three-model set
Consolidated register	Final section	A-L retrieval framework covers all printed syllabus limbs

Answer-worthiness. Theory of reality, *anekāntavāda*, *dravya-guṇa-paryāya*, *saptabhaṅgī*, material karma, bondage and liberation are **CORE SYLLABUS**. The Jaina pramāṇa scheme, seven *nayas*, karma taxonomy and *guṇasthānas* are **CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH** where they explain PYQs. Sectarian minutiae and unverified legal detail are not answer targets.

SESSION 1 - JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jainism is a liberation-centred realist philosophy that explains finite knowledge, karmic bondage and freedom through a many-sided account of reality.

Technical definition: Jain philosophy combines pluralistic realism, *anekāntavāda*, standpoint-conditioned predication and a material theory of karma within one soteriological system.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism links ontology, epistemology and ethics: reality has many aspects, finite judgments are standpoint-bound, and disciplined conduct removes material karmic bondage.

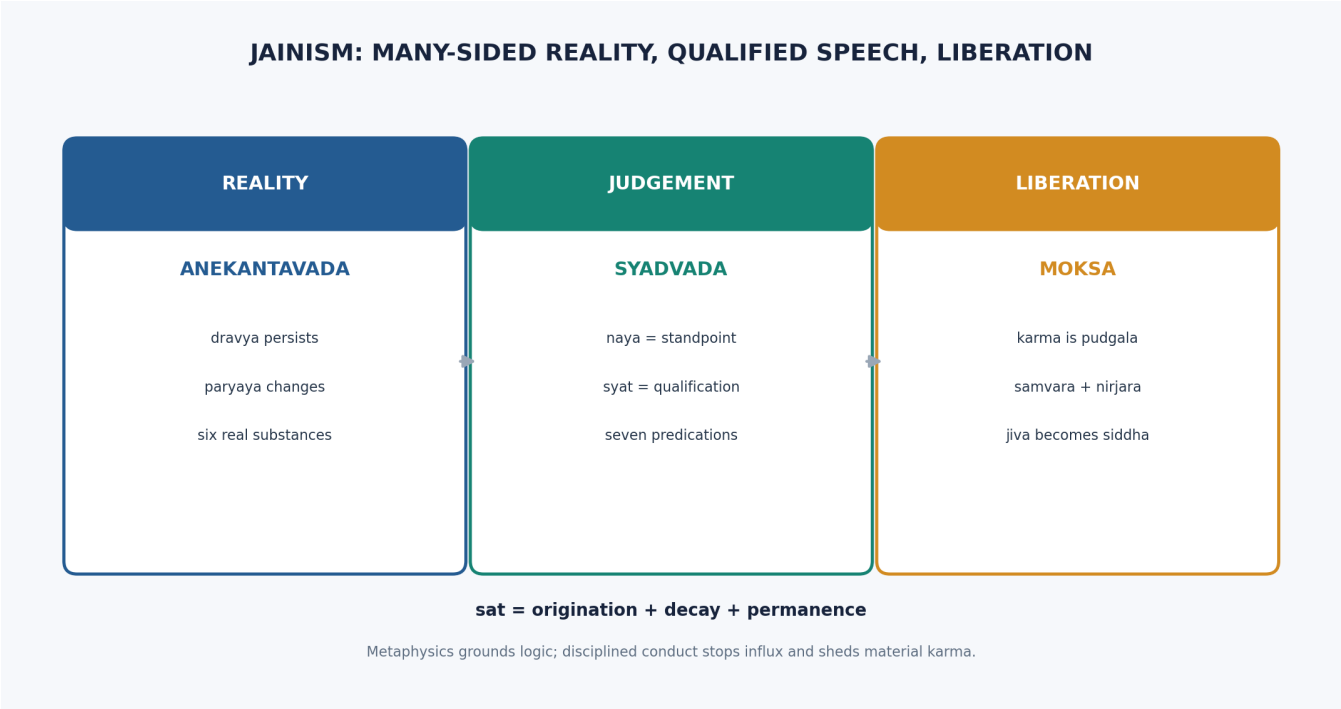
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Jainism
- jīva
- ajīva
- anekāntavāda
- karma
- triratna
- kevala-jñāna
- mokṣa

How to use them: Frame the answer through Jainism; define jīva, connect ajīva with *anekāntavāda* to explain the mechanism, and use karma for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Fact: A live August 2026 search primarily returned contemporary educational discussion of *anekāntavāda* and continuing ethical discussion of *sallekhanā*, not a clearly verified new court ruling in the February-August window.

ANALYSIS: **Inference:** Use *anekāntavāda* as a conceptual resource for intellectual humility and *sallekhanā* as a bounded ethics application. Do not invent a fresh legal development or let current application replace the printed metaphysics-logic-liberation syllabus.



Jainism system map

Doctrine	Level	One-line role
<i>Anekāntavāda</i>	metaphysics	reality has many objective aspects
<i>Nayavāda</i>	epistemology	finite knowledge grasps a standpoint
<i>Syādvāda</i>	semantics	assertions require conditional qualification
<i>Saptabhaṅgī</i>	formal expansion	seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility

Master verdict: Jainism is pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism and a material theory of karmic bondage; its unity lies in linking ontology, knowledge, conduct and liberation.

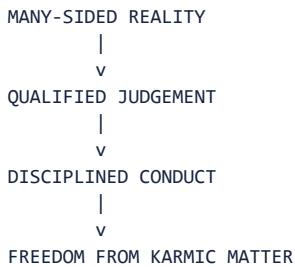
How to use this layered session

Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

Source audit: the repository Jainism knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 PYQ bank were checked; local OCR-searchable chapters in Chatterjee-Datta and C. D. Sharma were directly inspected. A live 2026 search found contemporary discussion of *anekāntavāda* and *sallekhanā*, used only as labelled conceptual application rather than doctrinal authority. Qdrant was not required.

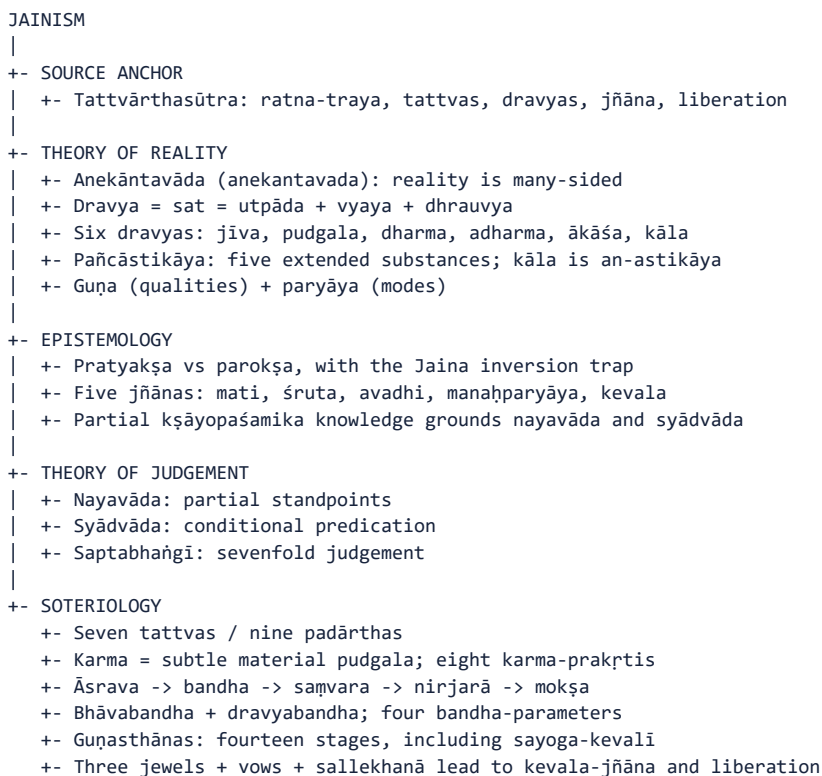
Preservation note: every substantive section of the previous complete Jainism session is retained below. The new material provides simpler gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing the original depth.

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START**Plain-language visual - the three connected pillars**

In simple words: Jainism is one connected philosophical system. Reality contains many genuine aspects; finite knowers see only some of them; statements must therefore be qualified; and right knowledge must transform conduct so that karmic bondage can end.

First anchor	Easy meaning
<i>Tattvārthasūtra</i>	Shared systematic text for the major Jaina traditions
Three jewels	Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct
Tirthaṅkara	Liberated teacher and ford-maker, not a creator God
Central movement	Reality -> knowledge -> conduct -> liberation

Memory line: Jainism joins realism, intellectual humility and self-purification.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC**ONE-SCREEN MAP****0A. UMĀSVĀTĪ / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA FACT:**

Statement. FACT: The *Tattvārthasūtra* or *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra* of **Umāsvāti** in Śvetāmbara usage and **Umāsvāmī** in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: It gives a compact doctrinal grammar for Jaina metaphysics, epistemology, ethics, bondage, and liberation.
2. FACT: Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.
3. FACT: It states the path through the **ratna-traya** (three jewels): **samyag-darśana** (right vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyak-cāritra** (right conduct).
4. FACT: It systematizes the seven tattvas, the five astikāyas plus kāla, and the classification of jñāna without reducing Jainism to only ethics or only logic.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A UPSC answer improves when Jainism is presented as a systematic darśana rather than as a loose collection of ascetic practices.

Distinction. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers and ford-makers, not creator Gods; Jainism remains **anīśvaravāda** (non-theistic about creation).

Example. FACT: The famous formulation that right vision, right knowledge, and right conduct together constitute the path to mokṣa may be safely used without inventing a sūtra number.

Objection (sectarian-history objection). CAUTION: A critic may ask whether a text accepted by both Śvetāmbaras and Digambaras erases real sectarian differences.

Reply. ANALYSIS: It does not erase them; it supplies a shared doctrinal framework within which disagreements about canon, practice, and interpretation can still remain.

Names to drop carefully. FACT:

- FACT: **Kundakunda**: Digambara thinker associated with *Samayasāra* and the **niścaya-naya / vyavahāra-naya** distinction.
- FACT: **Siddhasena Divākara** and **Samantabhadra**: important names in the early logic of anekānta and syādvāda.
- FACT: **Akalaṅka**, **Māṇikyanandi**, **Hemacandra**, and **Yaśovijaya**: major later Jaina logicians to cite for the mature pramāṇa tradition.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- Use this system map as the introduction to any 15- or 20-marker.
- A high-scoring opening states that Jainism is **pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage**.
- Do not spend more than two or three lines on sectarian history unless the question specifically asks for sources.
- The nine verified topic-owned PYQs are solved in the complete practice section and separate workbook.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Textual anchor: Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī and the *Tattvārthasūtra*.
- Path: *samyag-darśana* + *samyag-jñāna* + *samyak-cāritra*.
- No creator God; liberated teachers remain numerically distinct souls.
- Never reduce Jainism to either "seven viewpoints" or "non-violence" alone.

Progress: 2 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Theory of Reality: Anekānta, Dravya and the Sixfold Pluralism

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - permanence without freezing change

GOLD BRACELET
|
| reshaped
v
GOLD RING

gold persists = dhrauvya
bracelet-mode ends = vyaya
ring-mode begins = utpada

In simple words: a real thing can remain the same substance while its modes change. Jainism refuses both extremes: reality is neither a motionless block nor a series with no enduring identity.

Term	Easy meaning
<i>Dravya</i>	Enduring substance
<i>Guṇa</i>	Stable quality belonging to it
<i>Paryāya</i>	Changing mode or condition
<i>Anekāntavāda</i>	A real has many objective aspects
Six <i>dravyas</i>	Soul, matter, motion-medium, rest-medium, space and time

Memory line: the substance persists while modes originate and decay.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM

START / CONCEPT: JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM

EXACT TERMS: Jainism · jīva · ajīva · anekāntavāda · karma · triratna · kevala-jñāna · mokṣa

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Jīva becomes bound when passions attract karmic matter, while right faith, knowledge and conduct stop influx and shed accumulated karma.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Liberation requires both epistemic non-absolutism and rigorous ethical purification rather than mere intellectual assent.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not reduce anekāntavāda to relativism, because Jainism affirms a mind-independent plural reality while limiting finite predication.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Jainism links ontology, epistemology and ethics: reality has many aspects, finite judgments are standpoint-bound, and disciplined conduct removes material karmic bondage.

SESSION 2 - JĪVA, AJĪVA, DRAVYA, GUṆA AND PARYĀYA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Distinction. FACT: Guṇa is not the same as paryāya: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.

Technical definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which **anekāntavāda** (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring **dravya** (substance) possesses **guṇa** (qualities) and changing **pariyāya** (modes).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Jīva**
- **Ajīva**
- **Dravya**
- **Guṇa**
- **Pariyāya**
- **Anekāntavāda**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Jīva; define Ajīva, connect Dravya with Guṇa to explain the mechanism, and use Pariyāya for the decisive comparison or qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which **anekāntavāda** (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring **dravya** (substance) possesses **guṇa** (qualities) and changing **pariyāya** (modes).

1.1 Anekāntavāda as metaphysical thesis

Statement. FACT: **Anekāntavāda** is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

Argument. FACT:

1. Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.
2. Human cognition usually grasps only one aspect at a time.
3. Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.
4. A sound metaphysics must allow plurality of aspects within one real.
5. Hence reality is non-one-sided, or **anekānta**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Being is richer than any single finite judgement.

Distinction. FACT: **Anekāntavāda** is not mere indecision. It is a **metaphysical** claim about the complexity of reality, not yet the logical form of predication.

Example. FACT: A jar is permanent as a substance across a short stretch, changing in modes, describable by shape, use, material, and temporal state. No one predicate says all of this at once.

Objection (skeptical objection). FACT: If every object has indefinitely many aspects, knowledge may become impossible.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina thought replies that knowledge is possible precisely through qualified standpoints, not through absolutist simplification.

1.2 Dravya as sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya FACT:

Statement. FACT: The real (**sat**) is what possesses **utpāda** (origination), **vyaya** (decay), and **dhauvya** (persistence or permanence) together.

Argument. FACT:

1. Experience shows change: forms arise and pass.
2. Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.
3. Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.
4. Pure flux cannot explain identity.
5. Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.

6. This is articulated by saying substance is characterized by origination, decay, and permanence.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Both common-sense identity and experiential change are philosophically significant and must be preserved.

Distinction. FACT: This differs from Buddhist momentariness, which gives primacy to flux, and from strict monisms that absorb change into mere appearance.

Example. FACT: A gold ornament changes from bracelet to ring: modes originate and cease, yet the underlying substance persists.

Objection (Buddhist/Nyāya-style objection). FACT: How can opposite features-change and permanence-belong to one thing?

Reply. FACT: They belong in different respects: permanence as dravya, change as paryāya.

1.3 Six dravyas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically recognizes **six dravyas**: **jīva**, **pudgala**, **dharma**, **adharma**, **ākāśa**, and **kāla**.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The classification accounts for consciousness, matter, motion, rest, spatial accommodation, and temporal succession.
2. FACT: Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.
3. FACT: Five of the six dravyas are **astikāyas** (extended substances with many space-points or **pradeśas**).
4. FACT: **Kāla** (time) is a real dravya in the mainstream sixfold presentation, but it is **not** an astikāya; hence Jainism speaks of **pañcāstikāya** plus kāla.

The six dravyas. FACT:

Dravya	Basic sense	Role
Jīva	conscious substance	experiencer, knower, bearer of bondage and liberation
Pudgala	matter	corporeality, karmic matter, bodies, sense-objects
Dharma	medium of motion	condition making movement possible
Adharma	medium of rest	condition making rest possible
Ākāśa	space	accommodation for substances
Kāla	time	succession, change, sequence

Astikāya table. FACT:

Dravya	Astikāya ?	Function	Extension
Jīva	FACT: Yes	knowing, experiencing, agency, bondage and liberation	FACT: Has pradeśas; in embodied existence it is co-extensive with the body
Pudgala	FACT: Yes	material bodies, sense-objects, speech, breath, karma-pudgala	FACT: Extended and aggregative
Dharma-dravya	FACT: Yes	medium enabling motion	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa
Adharma-dravya	FACT: Yes	medium enabling rest	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa
Ākāśa	FACT: Yes	gives room or accommodation to substances	FACT: Extended as lokākāśa and alokākāśa
Kāla	WRONG: No	succession, duration, before-and-after, change	FACT: A dravya but an-astikāya because it lacks spatial extension across many pradeśas in the astikāya sense

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Reality is irreducibly pluralistic, and extension must be distinguished from substantiality.

Distinction. FACT: **Dharma** and **adharma** here do **not** mean moral merit and demerit; they mean media of motion and rest.

Sectarian note. FACT: The safe doctrinal point is: **kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya**; the pañcāstikāya list has five members, while the dravya list has six. CAUTION: A common sectarian nuance is that Digambara authors characteristically affirm real **kāla-aṇus** (time-atoms) associated with the space-points of lokākāśa, whereas some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of kāla as disputed or conventional.

Example. FACT: A fish swims because water is the medium enabling motion; analogically, dharma-dravya is the cosmic condition enabling movement, not motion itself.

Objection (Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika-style objection). FACT: Dharma and adharma as “media” look mysterious and unparsimonious.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina metaphysics treats them not as pushes or forces but as enabling conditions required for a coherent pluralistic cosmology.

1.4 Guṇa and paryāya FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every dravya possesses **guṇa** (essential qualities) and **paryāya** (modes or modifications).

Argument. FACT:

1. A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.
2. It must also undergo modal change or it would not participate in experience.
3. Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ontology must distinguish what remains from how it appears or changes.

Distinction. FACT: **Guṇa** is not the same as **paryāya**: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.

Example. FACT: Consciousness is a defining feature of jīva; pleasure, pain, delusion, or liberated omniscience are modes or conditions in which the jīva appears.

Objection (Buddhist nominalist objection). FACT: Why not just speak of changing qualities rather than introduce a substance?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Because changing qualities still presuppose something whose changes they are.

1.5 Jīva and ajīva FACT:

Statement. FACT: The most fundamental ontological distinction is between **jīva** (conscious) and **ajīva** (non-conscious).

Argument. FACT:

1. Experience distinguishes living, aware beings from inert entities.
2. This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.
3. Hence the universe divides into jīva and ajīva.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Consciousness is real and fundamental, not epiphenomenal.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman. Unlike Cārvāka, consciousness is not reducible to material organization.

Example. FACT: The body, speech, and even karmic matter belong to ajīva; the conscious experiencer bound by them is jīva.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: If jīva is immaterial, how can material karma affect it?

Reply. ANALYSIS: This becomes the central challenge in Jaina bondage theory and is answered through the doctrine of karmic influx and adhesion, though critics find the relation obscure.

1.6 Nature of jīva FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

Argument. FACT:

1. Liberation is meaningful only if the soul has a native capacity to realize perfection.
2. Bondage is then understood as obscuration, not total annihilation of that nature.
3. Therefore jīva is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Spiritual progress presupposes a real self capable of purification.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is pluralistic: there are many jīvas, not one universal self. It also differs from Nyāya, where the self is conscious through conjunction with mind; in Jainism consciousness belongs intrinsically to jīva.

Example. FACT: Souls are graded from one-sense beings to five-sense beings; even minute living entities are morally significant.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is naturally omniscient, ignorance becomes hard to explain.

Reply. FACT: Karma as obscuring matter is introduced precisely to explain the discrepancy between intrinsic capacity and empirical limitation.

1.7 Pudgala FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Pudgala** is the material dravya and the only dravya possessing **rūpa** (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.

Argument. FACT:

1. Corporeality, extension, and sensible quality require a material substrate.
2. Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.
3. Since karmic bondage has quasi-physical efficacy, karmic particles too are classed under pudgala.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Materiality is not illusory; it is an objective domain with its own laws.

Distinction. FACT: Pudgala is uniquely important because unlike jīva it is divisible, aggregative, and form-bearing.

Example. FACT: The body I inhabit, the food I consume, the dust in air, and karmic accretions all belong to pudgala.

Objection (Nyāya/Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: To call karma matter seems strange.

Reply. FACT: That strangeness is also Jainism's originality: bondage is not merely moral description but a real quasi-physical entanglement.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2019, Q6(a), 20 marks: define reality through *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya*, explain *dravya-guṇa-paryāya*, then show how this ontology requires qualified judgement.

2025, Q7(c), 15 marks: establish realism through mind-independent substances and pluralism through the six *dravyas* and many individual souls; then evaluate objections.

For comparison answers, use one axis at a time: permanence/change, number of ultimate realities, status of difference, self, and liberation.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- *Sat* = origination + decay + permanence.
- Six *dravyas*; five are *astikāyas*, while *kāla* is a dravya but not an *astikāya*.
- *Dharma* and *adharma* mean media of motion and rest, not merit and sin.
- *Jīva* is intrinsically conscious; *pudgala* alone possesses form and includes karmic matter.
- Trap: many-sided reality is objective pluralism, not subjective relativism.

Progress: 3 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Jaina Epistemology: Knowledge, Standpoints and the Omniscience Problem

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - why ordinary seeing is not the highest direct knowledge

SENSES + MIND
|
v
ordinary mediated knowledge
|
karma becomes thinner
v
higher direct knowledge
|
all obstruction removed
v
KEVALA-JNANA

In simple words: Jainism calls the soul's unmediated cognition truly direct. Ordinary perception depends on senses and mind, so it is direct only in everyday usage. As karmic obstruction decreases, wider forms of knowledge become possible.

Knowledge	Simple role
<i>Mati</i>	Sense-and-mind cognition
<i>Śruta</i>	Verbal or scriptural cognition
<i>Avadhi</i>	Limited direct knowledge beyond ordinary senses
<i>Manaḥparyāya</i>	Direct cognition of mental states
<i>Kevala</i>	Complete unobstructed knowledge

Memory line: knowledge is intrinsic to the soul but limited by karmic obstruction.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - JĪVA, AJĪVA, DRAVYA, GUṆA AND PARYĀYA

START / CONCEPT: JĪVA, AJĪVA, DRAVYA, GUṆA AND PARYĀYA
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Jīva · Ajīva · Dravya · Guṇa · Paryāya · Anekāntavāda
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Example. FACT: The body, speech, and even karmic matter belong to ajīva; the conscious experiencer bound by them is jīva.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Distinction. FACT: Guṇa is not the same as paryāya: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Six dravyas; five are astikāyas, while kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

SESSION 3 - PRAMĀṆA, KNOWLEDGE AND ANEKĀNTAVĀDA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

Technical definition: Argument. FACT: FACT: In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind. FACT: Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only sāṃvyaavahārika pratyakṣa (empirical or conventional direct knowledge). FACT: Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense-organs, mind, signs, and

karmic limitation. ANALYSIS: This reverses the usual classroom expectation that perception is the primary direct pramāṇa.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Statement. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Pramāṇa
- Knowledge
- Anekāntavāda
- pratyakṣa
- parokṣa
- sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa

How to use them: Frame the answer through Pramāṇa; define Knowledge, connect Anekāntavāda with pratyakṣa to explain the mechanism, and use parokṣa for the decisive comparison or qualification.

1A.1 Primary division: pratyakṣa and parokṣa FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology distinguishes **pratyakṣa** (direct knowledge) and **parokṣa** (indirect knowledge), but it uses the word pratyakṣa in a high-yield, non-ordinary way.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: In the strict Jaina sense, **pratyakṣa** means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.
2. FACT: Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only **sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa** (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).
3. FACT: Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense-organs, mind, signs, and karmic limitation.
4. ANALYSIS: This reverses the usual classroom expectation that perception is the primary direct pramāṇa.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Directness is measured by freedom from mediation and karmic obstruction, not merely by sensory vividness.

Distinction. FACT: Do not map Jaina pratyakṣa mechanically onto Nyāya pratyakṣa; the same term carries a different doctrinal weight.

Example. FACT: Seeing a pot with the eyes is conventionally direct in ordinary dealings, but **kevala-jñāna** is direct in the strict spiritual sense.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya may object that perception through sense-contact is the paradigm of direct cognition.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that sense-contact is direct only pragmatically; metaphysically it is mediated by organs, mind, and knowledge-obscuring karma.

1A.2 Five kinds of jñāna FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of **jñāna** (knowledge): **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Jñāna	Status	Meaning	UPSC trap
Mati-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa / conventional	sense-and-mind cognition	FACT: Ordinary perception is not strict pratyakṣa
Śruta-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa	scriptural, verbal, or sign-mediated knowledge derived from mati	FACT: Not blind faith; it depends on cognition and communication
Avadhi-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa	limited clairvoyant direct knowledge of material things	FACT: Direct but limited

Jñāna	Status	Meaning	UPSC trap
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa	direct knowledge of others' mental modes	FACT: Higher than avadhi, still not omniscience
Kevala-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa	unlimited, unmediated omniscience	FACT: The full overcoming of cognitive obstruction

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.
2. FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala are direct because the soul knows without ordinary sense-and-mind mediation.
3. FACT: The series shows graded release from karmic veiling.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Knowledge is graded according to the degree to which karmic obscuration is removed.

Distinction. FACT: The five jñānas are not five independent pramāṇas in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.

Example. FACT: A student's study of doctrine uses mati and śruta; the kevalin's omniscience is immediate and total.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala appear unverifiable to ordinary experience.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism treats them as necessary consequences of its soul-karma theory; a critic may still reject them if the ontology of jīva and karmic obstruction is denied.

1A.3 Wrong cognition: ajñāna under mithyā-darśana FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism recognizes **mati-ajñāna** or **kumati**, **śruta-ajñāna** or **kuśruta**, and **vibhaṅga-jñāna** as wrong cognition.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.
2. FACT: Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under **mithyā-darśana** (false vision or wrong orientation).
3. FACT: **Kumati** is misoriented sensory-mental cognition; **kuśruta** is misoriented verbal or scriptural cognition; **vibhaṅga-jñāna** is perverted avadhi.
4. ANALYSIS: The content may have some descriptive accuracy, but its orientation is false because it is governed by delusion.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Epistemology and ethics interpenetrate: how one is disposed affects how one knows.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina error is not only logical mistake; it can be a karmically conditioned mode of seeing.

Example. FACT: A learned person may quote doctrine but use it for pride, sectarian contempt, or violence; the verbal cognition then functions as kuśruta.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Calling cognition wrong because of spiritual orientation seems to confuse truth with moral psychology.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that bondage affects the knower as a whole; epistemic correctness without right vision remains incomplete for liberation.

1A.4 Later Jaina logic and indirect pramāṇas ANALYSIS:

Statement. FACT: Jainism admits **anumāna** (inference) and **śabda** (testimony or verbal authority) within parokṣa, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of indirect knowledge.

Argument. ANALYSIS:

1. FACT: **Akalaṅka**, **Māṇikyanandi**, **Hemacandra**, and **Yaśovijaya** are important names for the developed Jaina pramāṇa tradition.
2. ANALYSIS: Later Jaina logicians accept **smṛti** (recollection), **pratyabhijñā** (recognition), **tarka** or **ūha** (reasoning that grasps pervasion or vyāpti), and **anumāna** as valid indirect knowledge in appropriate contexts.
3. FACT: This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

4. ANALYSIS: The Jaina move protects continuity, recognition, and inferential preparation as genuine cognitive achievements without making them omniscient knowledge.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Valid cognition need not be restricted to fresh sense-contact; mediated cognition can still disclose real features of the object.

Distinction. FACT: **Śabda** is accepted as mediated knowledge, not as a creator-God's revelation; Jainism remains non-theistic about cosmic creation.

Example. FACT: Recognizing "this is the same teacher I met earlier" is not mere raw perception; it involves memory and recognition.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya can argue that memory merely reproduces past knowledge and is not a new pramāṇa.

Reply. ANALYSIS: The Jaina reply is that recollection and recognition can be valid cognition when they successfully connect present awareness with a real object or past experience.

1A.5 Critical link: pramāṇa -> nayavāda -> syādvāda FACT:

Statement. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Reality is **ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu**: the real object has infinitely many aspects, properties, and modes.
2. FACT: Ordinary human cognition is **kṣāyopaśamika** (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and is therefore necessarily partial.
3. FACT: A judgment made by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole object.
4. FACT: A partial judgment is true only relative to its standpoint; this is **nayavāda**.
5. FACT: Absolutising a partial standpoint yields **ekāntavāda** (one-sidedness), the root error of rival schools according to Jainism.
6. FACT: Therefore assertion must carry the operator **syāt** ("from a certain standpoint"); this is **syādvāda**.
7. FACT: The sevenfold schema of qualified predication is the disciplined expression of that standpoint-relativity; this is **saptabhaṅgī**.
8. FACT: Only **kevala-jñāna** grasps all aspects at once, because only omniscience is no longer karmically partial.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Finite cognition is not false simply because it is partial; it becomes false when it claims unconditioned finality.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina relativity is not subjectivism: the aspects are really in the object, but finite knowers access them partially.

Example. FACT: "The jar exists" is true with respect to its present substance-mode-place-time complex, but false with respect to another place, another time, or another incompatible mode.

Objection (Śaṅkara-style objection). FACT: If all assertions are standpoint-relative, the assertion of standpoint-relativity may also lose absolute force.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism accepts reflexive qualification: syādvāda too is asserted **syāt**, and its force lies in disciplined anti-absolutism rather than in an unqualified dogma.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The epistemology is essential to the **2023, Q5(a), 10 marks** quotation on empirical and relative knowledge. Test the quotation rather than accepting it: ordinary embodied cognition is relative, but Jainism admits non-sensory direct knowledge and **kevala-jñāna**.

In a 15-marker, move through: classification of knowledge -> karmic limitation -> partial standpoints -> conditional predication -> omniscience qualification -> critical burden.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Strict Jaina *pratyakṣa* is soul-direct, not ordinary sense perception.
- *Matī* and *śruta* are ordinary mediated cognition.
- *Avadhi*, *manahparyāya* and *kevala* are increasingly direct.
- Partial knowledge explains *naya*; it does not make external reality subjective.
- Trap: "all Jaina knowledge is empirical and relative" is false because of *kevala-jñāna*.

Progress: 4 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Nayavāda, Syādvāda and Saptabhaṅgī

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - one object, several valid questions

```
      CLAY JAR
     /   |   \
material? place? time?
  clay   here  present now
```

"It exists" is incomplete until the respect is stated.

In simple words: the same jar can exist here, fail to exist elsewhere, persist as clay, and change as a particular shape. Jainism asks us to attach the hidden condition to every claim rather than turning one partial truth into the whole truth.

Doctrine	Job
<i>Anekāntavāda</i>	Reality has many aspects
<i>Nayavāda</i>	A judgement selects a partial standpoint
<i>Syādvāda</i>	The assertion is explicitly qualified
<i>Saptabhaṅgī</i>	Seven ordered combinations of is, is-not and inexpressible

Memory line: many-sided object -> partial standpoint -> conditional sentence -> sevenfold expansion.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRAMĀṆA, KNOWLEDGE AND ANEKĀNTAVĀDA

START / CONCEPT: PRAMĀṆA, KNOWLEDGE AND ANEKĀNTAVĀDA

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Pramāṇa · Knowledge · Anekāntavāda · pratyakṣa · parokṣa · sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Argument. FACT: In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind. FACT: Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa (empirical or conventional direct knowledge). FACT: Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense-organs, mind, signs, and karmic limitation. ANALYSIS: This reverses the usual classroom expectation that perception is the primary direct pramāṇa.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Distinction. FACT: The five jñānas are not five independent pramāṇas in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya can argue that memory merely reproduces past knowledge and is not a new pramāṇa.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Statement. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

SESSION 4 - NAYAVĀDA, SYĀDVĀDA AND SAPTABHAṄGĪ

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

Technical definition: Statement. FACT: Nayavāda teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a naya, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Statement. FACT: The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Nayavāda
- Syādvāda
- Saptabhaṅgī
- naya
- seven nayas
- Naigama naya

How to use them: Frame the answer through Nayavāda; define Syādvāda, connect Saptabhaṅgī with naya to explain the mechanism, and use seven nayas for the decisive comparison or qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

2.1 Nayavāda: standpoint-theory

Statement. FACT: **Nayavāda** teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a **naya**, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

Argument. FACT:

1. Reality is many-sided.
2. Finite knowers rarely grasp all sides at once.
3. Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.
4. A doctrine of standpoints is needed to explain how partial truth is possible.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Partiality is not falsehood; it becomes falsehood only when the partial is absolutized.

Distinction. FACT: Nayavāda is not skepticism. It permits truth, but qualified truth.

Example. FACT: A jar may be described as clay, as container, as round, as breakable, as existing-now. Each statement is true from a standpoint.

Objection (Nyāya-style objection). FACT: Standpoints may proliferate without limit.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina thinkers classify principal standpoints to discipline rather than dissolve discourse.

2.2 The seven nayas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Classical Jainism enumerates **seven nayas**, each marking a characteristic standpoint.

Naya	Brief meaning
Naigama naya	common or teleological standpoint; mixed, unspecialized practical view
Samgraha naya	generic standpoint; emphasis on class-character
Vyavahāra naya	practical or particular standpoint; ordinary usage about specific things

Naya	Brief meaning
R̥jusūtra naya	momentary or present-state standpoint
Śabda naya	verbal standpoint; attention to linguistic expression
Samabhirūḍha naya	etymological or strictly differentiated verbal standpoint
Evambhūta naya	actuality-conditioned verbal standpoint; a term applies when the function is being performed

Argument. FACT: The list shows that partiality may arise from pragmatic, generic, particular, temporal, and linguistic conditioning.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

Distinction. FACT: Do not confuse **nayas** (standpoints) with the **sevenfold predications** of syādvāda. The former are epistemic perspectives; the latter are structured propositional forms.

Example. FACT: Calling a person “a singer” may be true generically or dispositionally, but **evambhūta naya** is stricter: the term applies in the relevant performance-actuality.

Objection (examiner's objection). FACT: The linguistic nayas seem overly scholastic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.

2.3 Syādvāda as logical expression

Statement. FACT: **Syādvāda** is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification **syāt**—“in some respect,” “from a certain standpoint,” or “conditionally.”

Argument. FACT:

1. Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.
2. Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.
3. The particle **syāt** prevents absolutization.
4. Hence syādvāda is the logical-linguistic expression of anekāntavāda.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Good logic mirrors ontological complexity and epistemic modesty.

Distinction. FACT: Anekāntavāda = metaphysical doctrine; nayavāda = theory of standpoints; syādvāda = mode of conditional predication.

Example. FACT: “The jar exists” becomes “syād asti”—it exists in some respect, e.g., as present on the floor now.

Objection (Śaṅkara-style objection). FACT: Constant qualification may weaken assertoric force.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina logic accepts that precision is preferable to dogmatic simplicity.

2.4 Saptabhaṅgī: the seven predications, exactly and in order FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **saptabhaṅgī** is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier **syāt**.

1. **syād asti** - in some respect, it is.
2. **syād nāsti** - in some respect, it is not.
3. **syād asti ca nāsti ca** - in some respect, it is and it is not.
4. **syād avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is indescribable.
5. **syād asti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is and is indescribable.
6. **syād nāsti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is not and is indescribable.
7. **syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is, is not, and is indescribable.

Argument. FACT:

1. A thing may be affirmed under one standpoint.
2. Negated under another.

3. Both affirmed and negated under different references or times.
4. Called indescribable where simultaneous exhaustive predication fails.
5. Combinations of these yield seven basic structured forms.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Contraries need not violate logic when they are indexed to standpoint, time, relation, or mode.

Distinction. FACT: “Indescribable” does not mean mystical silence simpliciter. It means that an unqualified or simultaneous statement is not straightforwardly expressible.

Example. FACT: A clay jar exists now on the table; it does not exist as a lump of raw clay; it both is and is not under different modal descriptions; in a complex state of transition it may be called avaktavya.

Objection (Śaṃkara/Rāmānuja objection). FACT: Critics say this violates non-contradiction.

Reply. FACT: The Jaina response is that contradiction would arise only if affirmation and negation were made in the same respect at the same time in the same sense. Syāt blocks that absolutist reading.

2.5 Blind men and the elephant FACT:

Statement. FACT: The familiar illustration of the blind men and the elephant captures the spirit of anekāntavāda: each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.

Argument. ANALYSIS: The illustration dramatizes the difference between **partial correctness** and **exclusive completeness**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

Distinction. FACT: The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is not itself the formal doctrine.

Example. FACT: One touches the trunk and says “the elephant is like a serpent,” another the leg and says “like a pillar.” Each is conditionally right and absolutely wrong.

Objection (pedagogical objection). FACT: The parable may trivialize complex metaphysics.

Reply. ANALYSIS: It is pedagogical, not probative; its use is to clarify the structure of partial truth.

2.6 Five kinds of knowledge FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology commonly speaks of **five kinds of knowledge**: **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Kind of knowledge	Basic sense
Mati-jñāna	sensory-mental cognition, ordinary empirical knowledge
Śruta-jñāna	scriptural/verbal knowledge, mediated through signs and teaching
Avadhi-jñāna	clairvoyant knowledge of material things beyond ordinary sense range
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	telepathic knowledge of mental states
Kevala-jñāna	perfect omniscience

Argument. FACT: The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction from cognition.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul’s purity.

Distinction. FACT: In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of knowledge with the seven nayas or the sevenfold predications.

Example. FACT: The ordinary learner begins with mati and śruta, while the liberated or near-liberated soul culminates in kevala-jñāna.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Higher forms seem unverifiable.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Within Jainism they are internally connected to the ontology of soul and karma; externally they remain open to critical challenge.

2.7 Standard objection: is anekāntavāda self-refuting or trivial? FACT:

Statement. FACT: Critics argue either that anekāntavāda is self-refuting-because the claim that “all reality is many-sided” is itself made absolutely-or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. If every assertion must be qualified, then the doctrine itself must be qualified.
2. If qualified, it may lose universal force.
3. If unqualified, it violates its own rule.
4. Alternatively, if it merely says that things can be looked at in different ways, it seems philosophically thin.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A doctrine of relativity must explain its own status.

Reply. FACT:

1. Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is also expressible from a standpoint.
2. This does not collapse it; it exhibits the very discipline it teaches.
3. The thesis is not that all statements are equally true, but that truth is aspect-conditioned.
4. Its philosophical bite lies in reconciling plurality with realism, not in banal relativism.

2.8 Does Jaina non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022) ANALYSIS:

Statement. ANALYSIS: A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.

Argument of the challenge. FACT:

1. The doctrine claims universal scope.
2. Universal scope appears absolute.
3. Therefore the doctrine seems to rely on the very absolutism it criticizes.

Jaina reply. FACT:

1. Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.
2. The doctrine is a methodological and ontological caution against ekānta, not a ban on all graded comprehensiveness.
3. Within Jainism, **kevala-jñāna** represents total knowledge, while ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound.
4. Hence the charge succeeds only if one confuses finite judgement with omniscient cognition.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: This is a subtle and strong reply: Jainism can admit a difference between omniscience and ordinary language without abandoning its critique of dogmatic partiality.

2.9 Is Jainism pluralistic and realistic? (2025) ANALYSIS:

Statement. ANALYSIS: Yes, Jainism is strongly **pluralistic** and broadly **realistic**, though both labels require nuance.

Why pluralistic. FACT:

1. It accepts many real souls.
2. It accepts multiple irreducible dravyas.
3. It rejects monistic reduction.
4. Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

Why realistic. FACT:

1. It treats dravyas, qualities, and modes as objectively real.
2. The external world is not illusion.
3. Knowledge aims at real objects, though only under standpoints.

Nuance. ANALYSIS: Its realism is **qualified realism**, because judgement is standpoint-indexed. But qualification of knowledge does not imply unreality of the object.

Objection (realist objection). FACT: If all knowledge is relative to standpoint, realism weakens.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism separates ontological realism from epistemic non-absolutism: reality is objective, but our finite access to it is partial.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2021, Q7(c), 15 marks: define the doctrinal chain, list all seven predicates in order, apply one jar example, block the contradiction objection, and conclude that this is disciplined conditional predication.

2022, Q6(b), 15 marks: reconstruct the absolutism objection fairly, distinguish non-absolutism from sceptical relativism, use *kevala-jñāna* as the Jaina reply, and concede the residual burden.

2023, Q5(a), 10 marks: qualify the quotation "all human knowledge is empirical and relative" using the fivefold knowledge scheme.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

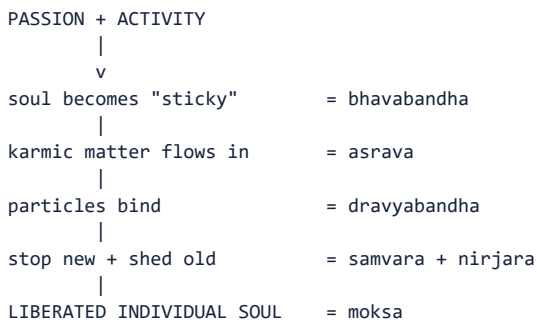
Rapid recall

- Seven *nayas* are standpoint disciplines; seven *bhaṅgas* are predicative forms.
- *Syāt* means "in some respect", not "perhaps" or mere probability.
- Third form asserts is-and-is-not successively or under different qualifications.
- *Avaktavya* marks the limit of one simple utterance, not total unknowability.
- Trap: the blind-men-and-elephant story illustrates partiality, not equality of all opinions.

Progress: 5 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Bondage, Karma, Spiritual Stages and Liberation

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the dust and wet-cloth model



In simple words: anger, pride, deceit and greed create the inner condition for bondage. Subtle karmic matter then attaches to the soul and obscures its natural knowledge. Liberation removes the obstruction; it does not create a new soul.

Core term	Easy meaning
<i>Āsrava</i>	Influx of karmic matter
<i>Bandha</i>	Binding
<i>Samvara</i>	Stopping new influx
<i>Nirjarā</i>	Shedding old karma
<i>Mokṣa</i>	Complete freedom with individuality retained

Memory line: inner passion causes material bondage; restraint stops it and discipline removes it.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - NAYAVĀDA, SYĀDVĀDA AND SAPTABHAṄĠĪ

START / CONCEPT: NAYAVĀDA, SYĀDVĀDA AND SAPTABHAṄĠĪ

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Nayavāda · Syādvāda · Saptabhaṅgī · naya · seven nayas · Naigama naya

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Reply. ANALYSIS: They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Distinction. FACT: Do not confuse nayas (standpoints) with the sevenfold predications of syādvāda.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Distinction. FACT: In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of knowledge with the seven nayas or the sevenfold predications.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Statement. FACT: The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

SESSION 5 - KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

Technical definition: Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāvabandha; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is dravyabandha.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Karmic Bondage
- Triratna
- Liberation
- pudgala
- material
- āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa

How to use them: Frame the answer through Karmic Bondage; define Triratna, connect Liberation with pudgala to explain the mechanism, and use material for the decisive comparison or qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

3.1 Karma as subtle material substance

Statement. FACT: Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that **karma is a subtle material substance**, a form of **pudgala** that flows toward and binds the soul.

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul's intrinsic omniscience is obscured in empirical life.
2. This obscuration requires a real binding factor.
3. That factor is karma, conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.
4. Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ethical and cognitive defilement must have a concrete causal structure.

Distinction. FACT: This is a crucial UPSC trap: in Jainism karma is **material**, unlike many Hindu presentations where karma is a moral force, merit-demerit ledger, or adṛṣṭa.

Example. FACT: Passions attract karmic particles just as a sticky surface gathers dust.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can matter bind a conscious immaterial soul?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism answers through intimate association and obscuration, though critics often say the mechanism remains conceptually difficult.

3.2 The fivefold soteriological sequence FACT:

Statement. FACT: The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence **āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa**.

Stage	Meaning
Āsrava	influx of karmic matter into the soul
Bandha	bondage; karmic matter adheres to the soul
Saṃvara	stoppage of fresh inflow
Nirjarā	shedding or exhaustion of accumulated karma
Mokṣa	complete release from karma

Argument. FACT:

1. Wrong belief, passions, and activity open the soul to karmic influx.
2. Influx produces bondage.
3. Discipline blocks new inflow.
4. Austerity and purification burn off old karma.
5. When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Spiritual progress is both preventive and purgative.

Distinction. FACT: Saṃvara and nirjarā are not the same: one stops new karma; the other removes old karma.

Example. FACT: Closing a muddy stream into a tank is like saṃvara; cleaning the sediment already deposited is like nirjarā.

Objection (Buddhist/Vedānta-style objection). FACT: The process may seem mechanically moralistic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Its strength is exactly its causal clarity: vice has ontological consequence; discipline has ontological remedy.

3.3 Bhāva-bandha and dravya-bandha (2024) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Bondage has two closely related forms: **bhāva-bandha** (psychic bondage) and **dravya-bandha** (material bondage).

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passions, attachment, aversion, delusion, and wrong disposition.
2. This inner deformation is **bhāva-bandha**.
3. Corresponding karmic particles then attach materially to the soul.
4. This actual material adhesion is **dravya-bandha**.
5. Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Inner states are causally efficacious; moral psychology precedes material karmic accretion.

Distinction. FACT:

- **Bhāvabandha** = subjective, intentional, affective bondage.
- **Dravyabandha** = objective, material bondage by karmic pudgala.

Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāvabandha; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is dravyabandha.

Objection (analytical objection). FACT: Why not collapse them into one process?

Reply. FACT: The distinction helps Jainism explain both moral agency and ontological consequence: one is the soul's state, the other is the karmic material result.

3.4 The three jewels FACT:

Statement. FACT: Liberation requires the **three jewels (ratnatraya)**: **samyag-darśana** (right faith/vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyag-cāritra** (right conduct).

Argument. FACT:

1. One must first see reality correctly.
2. One must know it correctly.
3. One must live in accordance with that insight.
4. Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop karmic influx.
5. Mere conduct without right view lacks orientation.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.

Distinction. FACT: The three jewels are not sequential in a crude external sense; they are mutually reinforcing dimensions of one path.

Example. FACT: One who knows non-violence conceptually but continues harmful conduct has not completed the path.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Is "faith" here blind belief?

Reply. FACT: No. Samyag-darśana is right apprehension or trustful orientation to truth, not irrational fideism.

3.5 Five mahāvratas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Right conduct is classically articulated through the **five mahāvratas**: **ahiṃsā**, **satya**, **asteya**, **brahmacarya**, and **aparigraha**.

Argument. FACT: These vows reduce passions, prevent harmful activity, and therefore check karmic influx.

Vow	Basic meaning	Soteriological relevance
Ahiṃsā	non-violence	central because injury binds karma deeply
Satya	truthfulness	purifies speech and intention
Asteya	non-stealing	curbs acquisitive harm
Brahmacarya	chastity / control of sensuality	disciplines desire
Aparigraha	non-possession / non-attachment	reduces grasping and karmic adhesion

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ethical discipline is metaphysically effective, not merely socially good.

Distinction. FACT: In Jainism ahiṃsā is not only a moral ideal but a central soteriological technology.

Example. FACT: Extreme care toward even one-sense beings follows from the pluralistic doctrine of jīva.

Objection (householder-pragmatic objection). FACT: Such rigor seems too severe for ordinary life.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes full vows for ascetics and limited observances for householders, preserving the ideal while allowing graded practice.

3.6 Kevala-jñāna FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Kevala-jñāna** is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul is intrinsically omniscient.
2. Ignorance is due to karmic obstruction.
3. Remove the obstruction and the native luminosity manifests completely.
4. Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Perfection is recovery, not production ex nihilo.

Distinction. FACT: Kevala-jñāna differs from scriptural knowledge and extraordinary clairvoyance; it is total, direct, unobstructed knowledge.

Example. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkara is revered as one who attained such perfect knowledge.

Objection (Buddhist/Cārvāka objection). FACT: Omniscience seems excessive or unverifiable.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Within Jaina metaphysics, omniscience is the natural terminus of complete karmic purification.

3.7 Mokṣa FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Mokṣa** is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to **siddha-śīlā**.

Argument. FACT:

1. Bondage is due to karmic accretion.
2. Complete stoppage and exhaustion of karma eliminate bondage.
3. The soul then manifests its intrinsic excellences unobstructed.
4. Being no longer weighed down by karmic matter, it rises to the topmost region of the cosmos.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation is individual and cosmologically locatable within the Jaina universe.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman. Unlike Buddhist nirvāṇa, it is liberation of a distinct enduring jīva.

Example. FACT: The liberated soul is a **siddha**, no longer embodied, no longer karmically entangled.

Objection (modern philosophical objection). FACT: Spatial ascent of a liberated soul may seem mythic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: In doctrinal exposition, one should report the cosmological picture faithfully while separating canonical doctrine from modern philosophical evaluation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION

START / CONCEPT: KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Karmic Bondage · Triratna · Liberation · pudgala · material · āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Reply. FACT: The distinction helps Jainism explain both moral agency and ontological consequence: one is the soul's state, the other is the karmic material result.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Unlike Buddhist nirvāṇa, it is liberation of a distinct enduring jīva.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

SESSION 6 - SEVEN TATTVAS, NINE PADĀRTHAS AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: The nine padārthas are the same seven tattvas plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).

Technical definition: Statement. FACT: The seven tattvas (real categories for liberation-analysis) are jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā, and mokṣa.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Statement. FACT: The nine padārthas are the same seven tattvas plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Seven Tattvas
- Nine Padārthas
- Karma-Prakṛtis
- tattvas
- jīva
- ajīva

How to use them: Frame the answer through Seven Tattvas; define Nine Padārthas, connect Karma-Prakṛtis with tattvas to explain the mechanism, and use jīva for the decisive comparison or qualification.

3A.1 Seven tattvas FACT:

Statement. FACT: The seven **tattvas** (real categories for liberation-analysis) are **jīva**, **ajīva**, **āsrava**, **bandha**, **saṃvara**, **nirjarā**, and **mokṣa**.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Jīva** and **ajīva** identify the two broad ontological poles.
2. FACT: **Āsrava** explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.
3. FACT: **Bandha** explains how that matter becomes bound.
4. FACT: **Saṃvara** explains the stopping of new influx.
5. FACT: **Nirjarā** explains the shedding or wearing away of accumulated karma.
6. FACT: **Mokṣa** names the final state when all karmic bondage is absent.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Metaphysics is organized around soteriology: the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.

Distinction. FACT: The tattva-list moves from what exists to what binds and what liberates.

Example. FACT: A person's anger is not merely a mental event; it opens āsrava, deepens bandha, and must be countered by saṃvara and nirjarā.

Objection (Buddhist-style objection). FACT: The list seems to reify a permanent soul and material karma beyond observable process.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that without jīva and karma-pudgala, bondage and liberation cannot be explained as real transformation of an enduring knower.

3A.2 Nine padārthas FACT:

Statement. FACT: The nine **padārthas** are the same seven tattvas plus **puṇya** (merit) and **pāpa** (demerit).

Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Seven tattvas	FACT: jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā, mokṣa	FACT: Standard liberation-sequence framework

Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Nine padārthas	FACT: the seven plus puṇya and pāpa	FACT: Makes moral valence explicit

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Puṇya and pāpa are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect karmic bondage.
2. ANALYSIS: They can also be subsumed under āsrava and bandha because both merit and demerit are forms of karmic involvement.
3. ANALYSIS: Hence some expositions emphasize seven for soteriological mechanics and nine for moral classification.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Even “good” karma remains karmic bondage if it keeps the soul within saṃsāra.

Distinction. FACT: Puṇya is better than pāpa ethically, but both are to be transcended for mokṣa.

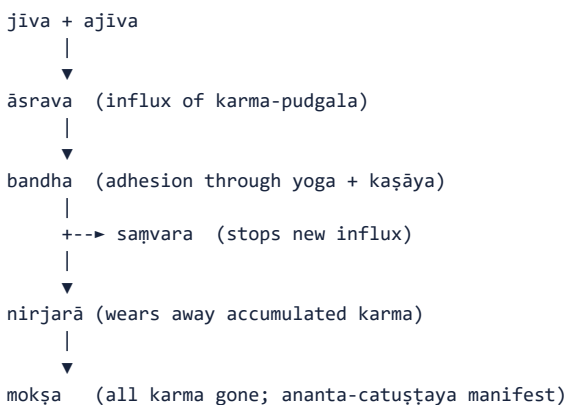
Example. FACT: Charity performed with attachment may produce puṇya, but liberation requires non-attachment rather than pleasant rebirth alone.

Objection (Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: If puṇya is morally valuable, why treat it as ultimately part of bondage?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes ethical improvement within saṃsāra from final release beyond all karmic determination.

3A.3 Soteriological flow: liberation by subtraction FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul’s **ananta-catuṣṭaya** (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.



Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The soul does not manufacture omniscience from nothing.
2. FACT: It removes what obscures its intrinsic cognitive and blissful capacity.
3. FACT: Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.
4. FACT: Mokṣa is the purified manifestation of what the jīva essentially is.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The self is intrinsically capable of perfection, but empirically veiled by beginningless karma.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina mokṣa is not acquisition of God’s grace, not merger into Brahman, and not annihilation of self; it is release of an individual jīva from karmic matter.

Example. FACT: Cleaning a sooted lamp does not create light; it allows light to shine unobstructed.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is intrinsically omniscient, why was it obscured at all?

Reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but purification can terminate the bondage.

3B. EIGHT KARMA-PRAKṚTIS AND THE MECHANICS OF BANDHA FACT:

3B.1 Karma is material pudgala FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: **karma-pudgala** is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Empirical ignorance, delusion, embodied limitation, status, pleasure-pain, and lifespan require causal explanation.
2. FACT: Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.
3. FACT: **Bhāva-karma** (the soul's psychical state) attracts **dravya-karma** (material karmic influx).
4. FACT: Thus passions and activities have ontological consequences, not merely psychological consequences.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Moral causation is not merely legal or symbolic; it is a real interaction between a modified soul and subtle matter.

Distinction. FACT: This differs sharply from Nyāya **adrṣṭa**, Mīmāṃsā **apūrva**, Sāṃkhya **saṃskāra**, and Buddhist **vāsanā**, which are not material karmic particles.

Example. FACT: Anger makes the soul "sticky," as oil or wet clay gathers dust; the image expresses the causal role of kaṣāya.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can material karma bind an immaterial conscious soul?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that the embodied jīva is not absolutely non-spatial: it has **pradeśas**, is co-extensive with the body, and is modified by bhāva-karma; karmic matter is attracted through passions. ANALYSIS: A residual difficulty remains because interaction between consciousness and matter still demands explanation.

3B.2 Eight basic karma-prakṛtis FACT:

Class	Karma-prakṛti	What it obscures or determines	Philosophical significance
Ghātiyā	FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya	knowledge	FACT: Blocks the soul's intrinsic knowing
Ghātiyā	FACT: Darśanāvaraṇīya	perception or apprehension	FACT: Blocks direct awareness
Ghātiyā	FACT: Mohanīya	right vision and conduct	FACT: Most dangerous because delusion misorients the path
Ghātiyā	FACT: Antarāya	energy, power, capacity to act	FACT: Obstructs the soul's effective power
Aghātiyā	FACT: Vedanīya	pleasure and pain	FACT: Determines felt experience without destroying essence
Aghātiyā	FACT: Nāma	body, form, embodiment	FACT: Determines the type of body and individuality of embodiment
Aghātiyā	FACT: Gotra	status or family-standing	FACT: Determines high or low status conditions
Aghātiyā	FACT: Āyus	lifespan	FACT: Determines duration of embodied life

Statement. FACT: The eight karmas divide into **ghātiyā** karmas, which damage or obscure the soul's essential qualities, and **aghātiyā** karmas, which determine embodiment without directly destroying those qualities.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya, and antarāya are ghātiyā because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation, and power.
2. FACT: Vedanīya, nāma, gotra, and āyus are aghātiyā because they structure embodied experience, body, status, and lifespan.
3. FACT: **Mohanīya** is the most dangerous because delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct.
4. FACT: Mohanīya is commonly divided into **darśana-mohanīya** and **cāritra-mohanīya**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation requires not only moral improvement but precise removal of the karmic veils that obstruct the soul's essential nature.

Distinction. FACT: The arhat at the **sayoga-kevalī** stage has destroyed ghātiyā karmas but still lives with remaining aghātiyā karmas until final release.

Example. FACT: A kevalin has omniscience because knowledge-obscuring karma is destroyed, but embodied life continues until lifespan-determining karma is exhausted.

Objection (Buddhist objection). FACT: The taxonomy seems metaphysically heavy compared with a mental-volitional account of karma.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism accepts the heaviness because it wants a realist explanation of why cognition, embodiment, status, pleasure, and lifespan are all karmically structured.

3B.3 Four parameters of bandha FACT:

Statement. FACT: Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: **prakṛti** (type or nature), **sthiti** (duration), **anubhāga** or **rasa** (intensity), and **pradeśa** (quantity of karmic matter).

Bandha-parameter	Meaning	Main determinant
Prakṛti	FACT: type of karma bound	FACT: Yoga (activity of body, speech, and mind)
Sthiti	FACT: duration of bondage	FACT: Kaṣāya (passions)
Anubhāga / rasa	FACT: intensity or fruition-strength	FACT: Kaṣāya
Pradeśa	FACT: quantity of karmic matter bound	FACT: Yoga

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Yoga** brings karmic matter into relation with the soul and determines type and quantity.
2. FACT: **Kaṣāya** makes the bondage deep, long-lasting, and intense.
3. FACT: Activity without passion therefore has a radically different karmic effect from activity with passion.
4. FACT: This explains the contrast between **īryāpathika bandha** (momentary bondage from activity without passion) and **sāmparāyika bandha** (durable bondage from passion-coloured activity).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment, and delusion.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is not crude physicalism: material karma binds through psychical states; passion is doctrinally decisive.

Example. FACT: A monk's careful walking may involve bodily activity, but if free from passion it binds only momentarily; an angry act binds deeply because kaṣāya fixes the karma.

Objection (Mīmāṃsā-Nyāya objection). FACT: This mechanism seems more elaborate than needed to explain moral consequence.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that the elaboration is the point: it explains why intention, passion, duration, intensity, and embodiment are linked in a single karmic science.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SEVEN TATTVAS, NINE PADĀRTHAS AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

START / CONCEPT: SEVEN TATTVAS, NINE PADĀRTHAS AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Seven Tattvas · Nine Padārthas · Karma-Prakṛtis · tattvas · jīva · ajīva

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Statement. FACT: The seven tattvas (real categories for liberation-analysis) are jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā, and mokṣa.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Distinction. FACT: Jaina mokṣa is not acquisition of God's grace, not merger into Brahman, and not annihilation of self; it is release of an individual jīva from karmic matter.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is anādi (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but purification can terminate the bondage.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Statement. FACT: The nine padārthas are the same seven tattvas plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).

SESSION 7 - GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Statement. FACT: The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

Technical definition: Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Statement. FACT: The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Guṇasthānas
- Sallekhanā
- The Ascent To Kevala
- Mithyā-dṛṣṭi
- Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna
- Miśra / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi

How to use them: Frame the answer through Guṇasthānas; define Sallekhanā, connect The Ascent To Kevala with Mithyā-dṛṣṭi to explain the mechanism, and use Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna for the decisive comparison or qualification.

3C.1 Ordered list FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **guṇasthānas** are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

No.	Guṇasthāna	Brief gloss
1	FACT: Mithyā-dṛṣṭi	false vision; complete wrong orientation
2	FACT: Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna	falling condition with a lingering taste of right vision
3	FACT: Miśra / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi	mixed right and wrong orientation

No.	Guṇasthāna	Brief gloss
4	FACT: Avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi	right vision without full restraint
5	FACT: Deśavirata	partial restraint, especially lay vows
6	FACT: Pramatta-saṃyata	full restraint with negligence
7	FACT: Apramatta-saṃyata	full restraint without negligence
8	FACT: Apūrvā-karaṇa / nivṛtti-bādara	unprecedented purification; gross passions being transformed
9	FACT: Anivṛtti-bādara	further advanced purification of gross passions
10	FACT: Sūkṣma-samparāya	only subtle greed remains
11	FACT: Upaśānta-moha	delusion suppressed, not destroyed
12	FACT: Kṣiṇa-moha	delusion destroyed
13	FACT: Sayoga-kevalī	omniscient embodied arhat with activity still present
14	FACT: Ayoga-kevalī	activity ceases; momentary final state before siddhatva

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The first three stages describe wrong, falling, or mixed vision.
2. FACT: Stage 4 is decisive because **samyag-darśana** first becomes stable enough to orient the path.
3. FACT: Stages 5-7 discipline conduct through partial and full restraint.
4. FACT: Stages 8-10 refine passions from gross to extremely subtle.
5. FACT: Stages 11-12 mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion.
6. FACT: Stages 13-14 explain how omniscience and final disembodiment are related.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation is gradual, psychologically exact, and karmically measurable.

Distinction. FACT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet complete ascetic conduct.

Example. FACT: A layperson with right vision and partial vows belongs doctrinally closer to stage 5 than to complete monastic purification.

Objection (Advaita-style objection). FACT: A fourteen-stage ladder may seem to turn liberation into a mechanical sequence rather than insight.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that insight, conduct, and karmic purification must be integrated; right vision without progressive destruction of karma is incomplete.

3C.2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina doctrine distinguishes **upaśama-śreṇi** (ladder of suppression) and **kṣapaka-śreṇi** (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Upaśama-śreṇi** suppresses delusion and can reach stage 11.
2. FACT: Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.
3. FACT: **Kṣapaka-śreṇi** destroys delusion and reaches stage 12 and beyond.
4. FACT: At stage 13 the **sayoga-kevalī** has kevala-jñāna but still retains embodied activity because aghātiyā karmas remain.
5. FACT: Stage 14, **ayoga-kevalī**, is the momentary cessation of activity immediately before **siddhatva**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Suppression is spiritually unstable; destruction alone is final.

Distinction. FACT: The sayoga-kevalī is the Jaina answer to “is jīvanmukti possible?”: the embodied omniscient arhat is liberated-in-life in the Jaina sense, though final siddha-state follows only after remaining aghātiyā karmas are exhausted.

Example. FACT: A lamp with its obscuring cover removed shines fully even before the lamp is relocated; similarly the arhat is omniscient while embodied.

Objection (Rāmānuja-style objection). FACT: Omniscience while embodied may seem unintelligible if embodiment itself implies limitation.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes ghātiyā karmas, which obstruct essential knowledge, from aghātiyā karmas, which sustain embodiment without blocking omniscience.

3D. SALLEKHANĀ / SANTHĀRĀ: DEATH WITHOUT PASSION FACT:

Statement. FACT: Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Bondage tracks **kaṣāya**: passion fixes karmic matter more deeply than bare activity.
2. FACT: A death faced with equanimity minimizes new influx and prevents panic, attachment, and aversion from creating fresh bondage.
3. FACT: The aim is not to end life as such but to end passion at the moment when life is already naturally or medically approaching its close.
4. FACT: The practice must be free from desire for death, desire to continue living, attachment to friends, recollection of pleasures, and hope of reward.
5. FACT: If such motives enter, the act becomes an **aticāra** (transgression) of the vow's proper discipline.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The karmic quality of dying depends on the inner state with which death is faced.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from **ātma-ghāta** (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

Example. FACT: An elderly ascetic or lay practitioner facing irreversible decline may gradually reduce intake under religious supervision while cultivating forgiveness, detachment, and equanimity.

Objection (modern legal-ethical objection). CAUTION: Critics in India have disputed whether sallekhanā is protected religious practice or an impermissible form of self-destruction.

Reply. ANALYSIS: The Jaina reply is that legal and ethical evaluation must distinguish intention, procedure, publicity, non-violence, and the absence of death-desire; the controversy is a useful Paper II bridge to religion and morality, but specific case names, holdings, dates, and statutory details should not be asserted unless separately verified.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2018, Q6(c), 15 marks: define bondage, distinguish bound and liberated souls, explain *bhāvabandha/dravyabandha*, and state the liberated condition.

2020, Q5(a), 10 marks and **2022, Q5(d), 10 marks:** focus on the bearing of material karma on liberation through *āsrava-bandha-saṁvara-nirjarā-mokṣa*.

2024, Q6(c), 15 marks: make the psychic/material distinction causal, not merely definitional, and add the four parameters of material bondage.

Use the three jewels and vows as mechanisms of *saṁvara* and *nirjarā*, not as an ornamental ethical list.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Karma is subtle material *pudgala*, not merely moral memory.
- Four *kaṣāyas*: anger, pride, deceit and greed.
- Seven *tattvas*; nine *padārthas* add merit and demerit.
- Eight karma-types divide into four destructive and four non-destructive classes.
- Four bandha parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.

- Liberation reveals intrinsic knowledge and bliss; individual *siddhas* do not merge.

Progress: 6 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Inter-School Debates and the Strongest Criticism-Reply Grid

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - what each rival attacks

BUDDHISM -> Why posit a permanent soul?
ADVAITA -> How can opposites be finally real?
NYAYA -> How does soul expand with the body?
CARVAKA -> Where is evidence for karma and omniscience?
JAINA REPLY -> each criticism absolutises one dimension

In simple words: rival schools attack different joints of the Jaina system. A good answer must name the target accurately before giving the Jaina reply.

Rival	Main pressure point
Buddhism	Permanence amid change
Advaita	Real plurality and opposed predicates
Nyāya	Soul-body extension and material karma
Cārvāka	Unverifiable soul, karma and omniscience

Memory line: state the critic's criterion first; then show what the Jaina distinction saves and what burden remains.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA

START / CONCEPT: GUṆASTHĀNAS, SALLEKHANĀ AND THE ASCENT TO KEVALA

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Guṇasthānas · Sallekhanā · The Ascent To Kevala · Mithyā-dṛṣṭi · Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna
· Miśra / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta (suicide):
suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion;
sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Distinction. FACT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet
complete ascetic conduct.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Example. FACT: A lamp with its obscuring cover removed shines fully even
before the lamp is relocated; similarly the arhat is omniscient while embodied.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Statement. FACT: The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking
the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

SESSION 8 - JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Inter-school comparison identifies how Jain realism and qualified predication differ from Buddhist process theory, Advaita non-dualism and Cārvāka materialism.

Technical definition: Jainism combines enduring substances with changing modes, thereby opposing Buddhist momentariness, Advaita's ultimate non-duality and Cārvāka's rejection of supersensible bondage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism occupies a distinctive middle position: it is realist without absolutist finite predication and pluralist without denying the disciplined possibility of truth.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Jain realism
- Buddhist momentariness
- Advaita non-dualism
- Cārvāka materialism
- anekāntavāda
- jīva
- karma
- comparison

How to use them: Frame the answer through Jain realism; define Buddhist momentariness, connect Advaita non-dualism with Cārvāka materialism to explain the mechanism, and use anekāntavāda for the decisive comparison or qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

4.1 Jainism vs Buddhism on reality

Axis	Jainism	Buddhism
Self	Many enduring jīvas	Anātman / no enduring self-substance
Reality	Substance with permanence-in-change	Strong tendency to momentariness in many schools
Logic of judgement	Conditional many-sided predication	Often sharper critiques of substantial identity
Karma	Material karmic accretion	Moral-causal continuity without material karmic particles
Liberation	Distinct soul freed from karma	Nirvāṇa without eternal self

4.2 Jainism vs Advaita Vedānta

Axis	Jainism	Advaita
Ultimate reality	Pluralistic	Non-dual Brahman
World	Real	Empirically real, ultimately dependent / mithyā
Souls	Many real jīvas	Ultimately one ātman/Brahman
Ignorance/bondage	Karmic material obscuration	Avidyā / adhyāsa
Liberation	Distinct siddhas	Realization of non-duality

4.3 Jainism vs Cārvāka

Axis	Jainism	Cārvāka
Ontology	Pluralist realism with soul and karma	Materialist minimalism
Karma	Material and real	Rejected
Liberation	Central	Denied or emptied
Logic	Conditional predication	Suspicion of inference and testimony
Ethics	Austerity and ahiṃsā	This-worldly pleasure and prudence

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON

START / CONCEPT: JAINISM IN INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISON

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Jain realism · Buddhist momentariness · Advaita non-dualism · Cārvāka materialism ·
anekāntavāda · jīva · karma · comparison

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The comparison turns on whether reality contains enduring substances, whether
a permanent self exists and whether karmic bondage is metaphysically real.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Jainism preserves plurality and persistence while explaining change through
modes, but rivals challenge the coherence of combining permanence and alteration.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not equate Jain non-absolutism with Buddhist emptiness or Advaita's
claim that plurality is ultimately sublated.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Jainism occupies a distinctive middle position: it is realist without
absolutist finite predication and pluralist without denying the disciplined possibility of truth.

SESSION 9 - NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jaina reply. FACT: FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: dravya (substance), kṣetra (place), kāla (time), and bhāva (mode). FACT: There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode. FACT: Syādvāda is itself asserted syāt; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule. ANALYSIS: A residual objection remains: if syādvāda is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

Technical definition: Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism replies through utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jaina reply. FACT: FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: dravya (substance), kṣetra (place), kāla (time), and bhāva (mode). FACT: There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode. FACT: Syādvāda is itself asserted syāt; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule. ANALYSIS: A residual objection remains: if syādvāda is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Named Criticisms
- Jain Replies
- dravya
- kṣetra
- kāla
- bhāva

How to use them: Frame the answer through Named Criticisms; define Jain Replies, connect dravya with kṣetra to explain the mechanism, and use kāla for the decisive comparison or qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

5.1 Śaṃkara's critique of anekāntavāda FACT:

Statement. FACT: Śaṃkara, in the *Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya*, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.
2. FACT: If everything is "somehow yes and somehow no," practical action loses clear guidance.
3. FACT: If anekāntavāda asserts itself absolutely, it contradicts itself.
4. FACT: If it asserts itself only conditionally, it seems to lose universal force.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A viable metaphysics must preserve non-contradiction and assertoric clarity.

Jaina reply. FACT:

1. FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: **dravya** (substance), **kṣetra** (place), **kāla** (time), and **bhāva** (mode).
2. FACT: There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode.
3. FACT: Syādvāda is itself asserted **syāt**; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule.
4. ANALYSIS: A residual objection remains: if syādvāda is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

5.2 Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes FACT:

Statement. FACT: Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.
2. FACT: If the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent.
3. FACT: If they are not real, Jaina realism weakens.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Real predication must avoid contradiction at the level of the object, not merely at the level of language.

Jaina reply. FACT: The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same dravya persists while paryāyas arise and cease, so the opposition is between aspects, not within one unqualified predication.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply works best if one accepts the dravya-paryāya distinction; it is less persuasive to schools that reject such aspect-realism.

5.3 Dharmakīrti / Buddhist critique of permanent-yet-changing soul FACT:

Statement. FACT: A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.
2. FACT: What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.
3. FACT: A permanent entity that changes faces the **arthakriyā** (causal efficacy) dilemma: if it acts, it changes; if it does not change, it cannot act.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Causal efficacy and permanence are difficult to combine in one substance.

Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism replies through **utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya**: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The Buddhist objection remains strong if one denies the real distinction between substance and modes.

5.4 Nyāya critique of the soul's expansion and material karma FACT:

Statement. FACT: Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.
2. FACT: If the self has parts or *pradeśas*, its eternality seems threatened.
3. FACT: Material karma is less parsimonious than an unseen moral potency such as *adrṣṭa*.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A permanent self should be partless or at least not spatially variable.

Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism invokes *pradeśas* and the lamp simile: consciousness can pervade the body without being identical with gross matter, and karmic pudgala explains concrete embodiment better than a merely invisible potency.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the interaction of conscious *pradeśa*-bearing *jīva* and matter remains a debated point.

5.5 Sāṃkhya/Vedānta critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage FACT:

Statement. FACT: Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul and what began the obscuration.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.
2. FACT: If karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.
3. FACT: If karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A theory of bondage must explain both its origin and its removal.

Jaina reply. FACT: The *jīva*-karma relation is *anādi* (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but disciplined *saṃvara* and *nirjarā* can terminate the relation.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply blocks a first-cause demand but leaves a metaphysical puzzle about why beginningless bondage is possible for an intrinsically perfect soul.

5.6 Cārvāka / empiricist critique of omniscience and liberation FACT:

Statement. FACT: A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and *siddha-śilā* as unverifiable.

Argument of the critic. FACT: Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied *siddhas*, or omniscient cognition.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

Jaina reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism combines testimony, inference, moral phenomenology, and the internal logic of purification to defend these doctrines, but it cannot satisfy a strict materialist who admits only gross perception.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: Use this objection only as an external critique; do not let it replace the named classical objections above.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

Use a four-column dialectic: **critic -> exact objection -> Jaina distinction/reply -> residual problem.**

For "critically discuss", exposition must come before criticism. For comparison, select named axes rather than writing two isolated summaries. The **2025 pluralism and realism** PYQ is the best place to integrate Buddhist, Advaita, Nyāya and Cārvāka pressure.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Criticism is strongest when its criterion is named.

- Indexed opposites answer contradiction better than the slogan "all views are true".
- Permanent substance explains continuity but increases ontological commitment.
- Material karma integrates ethics and embodiment but creates an interaction problem.
- Omniscience blocks total relativism but needs independent support.

Progress: 7 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: UPSC Synthesis, PYQ Routing and Answer Architecture

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the complete answer spine

```

DEFINE THE AXIS
|
RECONSTRUCT JAINA DOCTRINE
|
SHOW THE INTERNAL LINK
reality -> judgement -> conduct -> liberation
|
ADD NAMED OBJECTION + BEST REPLY
|
GIVE A QUALIFIED VERDICT
  
```

In simple words: a Jaina answer scores when it shows relationships. Do not merely list six substances, seven predicates or five stages; explain why each structure follows from the larger system.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Definition -> core mechanism -> distinction -> verdict
15	Doctrine -> structure/example -> criticism/reply -> assessment
20	Full derivation -> comparison -> dialectic -> criterion-based conclusion

Memory line: many-sided reality requires qualified judgement; purified judgement and conduct remove bondage.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

EXAM TRAPS, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE AND GRADED VERDICT

1. **Anekāntavāda ≠ syādvāda ≠ saptabhaṅgī.** FACT: Metaphysics / epistemic-logical method / formal sevenfold predication.
2. **Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala).** FACT: Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.
3. **Six dravyas, but only five astikāyas.** FACT: Kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya; the pañcāstikāya list has five members while the dravya list has six.
4. **Jainism rejects God as creator but not spiritual excellence.** FACT: Liberated souls and Tīrthaṅkaras are worthy of reverence, but there is no creator-God.
5. **Bhāvabandha ≠ dravyabandha.** FACT: Psychic bondage is not identical with material karmic bondage, though they are linked.
6. **Dharma / adharma in ontology do not mean moral merit / sin.** FACT: They are media of motion and rest.
7. **Seven nayas are not the same as seven bhāṅgas.** FACT: One is standpoint taxonomy; the other is predication schema.
8. **Jainism is realist despite epistemic relativity.** ANALYSIS: Partial knowledge does not imply unreal objects.
9. **Jaina pratyakṣa is inverted.** FACT: Strict pratyakṣa is soul-direct knowledge; ordinary sense-perception is only sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa.
10. **Puṇya is not mokṣa.** FACT: Merit may improve saṃsāric condition but still belongs to karmic involvement.
11. **Ghātiyā ≠ aghātiyā karma.** FACT: Ghātiyā karmas obstruct essential qualities; aghātiyā karmas determine embodiment.
12. **Sayoga-kevalī = Jaina jīvanmukta.** FACT: Omniscience can occur while embodied because aghātiyā karmas remain until final siddhatva.

7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK FACT:

- **Anekāntavāda** - doctrine of many-sided reality. FACT:
- **Sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya** - reality involves origination, decay, and permanence. FACT:
- **Dravya-guṇa-paryāya** - substance, qualities, modes. FACT:
- **Jīva / ajīva** - conscious and non-conscious reals. FACT:
- **Syādvāda** - conditional predication. FACT:
- **Saptabhaṅgī** - sevenfold judgement-schema. FACT:
- **Bhāvabandha / dravyabandha** - psychic and material bondage. FACT:
- **Ratnatraya** - right faith, right knowledge, right conduct. FACT:
- **Kevala-jñāna** - omniscience of the purified soul. FACT:
- **Siddha-śīlā** - topmost locus of liberated souls. FACT:
- **Exam sentence:** "Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints." ANALYSIS:
- **Exam sentence:** "The originality of Jaina soteriology lies in treating karma not merely as moral record but as subtle material bondage requiring both stoppage and shedding." ANALYSIS:

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Bound and liberated soul

- FACT: **Bondage:** karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.
- FACT: **Liberation sequence:** saṃvara stops new influx; nirjarā sheds accumulated karma; the purified jīva rises to the siddha-śīlā and remains an individual perfected soul.
- ANALYSIS: **Distinction:** the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.
- CAUTION: **Objection -> reply:** material karma interacting with an immaterial conscious jīva appears category-confused. Jainism treats karmic matter as subtle and invokes the jīva's embodied expansion/contraction, though the mechanism remains contestable.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018-2025 audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored papers require the mechanics of bondage, bound versus liberated soul, the condition of the siddha, and karma's direct bearing on liberation.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

7A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Anekāntavāda	ANALYSIS: Reality has many real aspects, not merely many subjective descriptions	ANALYSIS: Jaina non-absolutism becomes either skepticism or loose tolerance
Nayavāda	ANALYSIS: Finite cognition grasps objects through partial standpoints	ANALYSIS: Partial truths become either falsehoods or dogmatic absolutes
Syādvāda / saptabhaṅgī	ANALYSIS: Language must register standpoint, time, place, substance, and mode	ANALYSIS: Conditional predication looks like contradiction or indecision
Dravya as utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya	ANALYSIS: Permanence and change are both objectively real in different respects	ANALYSIS: Jainism collapses either into Buddhist flux or static monism
Five/six substances and astikāya	ANALYSIS: Substance and spatial extension must be distinguished	ANALYSIS: Kāla is confused with the five astikāyas, and pluralist cosmology loses precision
Material karma	ANALYSIS: Moral-psychical states can attract subtle matter	ANALYSIS: Bondage becomes metaphorical and Jaina soteriology loses its distinctive mechanism
Guṇasthāna progression	ANALYSIS: Spiritual development is gradual and karmically measurable	ANALYSIS: Liberation becomes abrupt insight without Jaina moral psychology
Kevala-jñāna	ANALYSIS: The soul's infinite knowledge is intrinsic but obscured	ANALYSIS: Mokṣa becomes acquisition rather than revelation through removal
Ahiṃsā	ANALYSIS: All living jīvas are morally significant and injury binds karma	ANALYSIS: Jaina ethics loses its metaphysical foundation

7B. PŪRVAPAKṢA-SIDDHĀNTA LEDGER FACT:

Objector (named)	Objection	Jaina reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
Śaṃkara	FACT: Anekāntavāda allows contradiction and cannot assert itself consistently	FACT: Predicates are indexed to dravya, kṣetra, kāla, and bhāva; syādvāda is itself asserted syāt	ANALYSIS: Reflexively qualified doctrine may seem to lose assertoric force
Rāmānuja	FACT: A real substance with opposed real attributes is unintelligible	FACT: Opposed predicates belong to different aspects of dravya and paryāya	ANALYSIS: Reply depends on accepting aspect-realism
Dharmakīrti / Buddhist	FACT: Permanent yet changing soul fails the arthakriyā test	FACT: Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya: permanence as dravya, change as paryāya	ANALYSIS: Strong if substance-mode distinction is denied
Nyāya	FACT: Soul's expansion/contraction and material karma are unparsimonious	FACT: Jīva has pradeśas and pervades the body like a lamp; karma-pudgala explains embodiment	ANALYSIS: Consciousness-matter interaction remains difficult
Sāṃkhya/Vedānta	FACT: Intrinsic omniscience plus beginningless obscuration seems puzzling	FACT: Jīva-karma relation is anādi but terminable through saṃvara and nirjarā	ANALYSIS: No first-origin explanation is offered
Cārvāka / empiricist	FACT: Soul, karma-pudgala, omniscience, and siddha-śilā are not perceptually verified	ANALYSIS: Jainism uses inference, testimony, and systematic soteriology	ANALYSIS: Unpersuasive to strict perception-only materialism

7C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING FACT:

School	Pramāṇas admitted	Self	Permanence vs change	Universals	Causation	Creator God	Liberation
Jainism	FACT: Pratyakṣa and parokṣa; developed accounts include anumāna, śabda, smṛti, pratyabhijñā, tarka	FACT: Many permanent jīvas	FACT: Dravya permanent, paryāya changing	ANALYSIS: Real features grasped under standpoints	FACT: Sadasat kāryavāda : effect exists in one respect in the cause because dravya persists, and does not exist in another because paryāya is new	FACT: Anīśvaravāda : no creator; Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers	FACT: Individual siddha freed from all karma
Buddhism	ANALYSIS: Usually perception and inference in classical epistemology	FACT: No permanent ātman	FACT: Momentariness in many schools	ANALYSIS: Often nominal or conceptual	ANALYSIS: Dependent origination, no permanent substrate	FACT: No creator God	FACT: Nirvāṇa without eternal soul-substance
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Perception, inference, comparison, testimony	FACT: Many eternal selves	FACT: Substances endure; qualities change	FACT: Universals real	FACT: Asatkāryavāda; effect newly produced	FACT: Theistic in later Nyāya	FACT: Self freed from suffering, not Jaina omniscient bliss
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	FACT: Perception, inference, reliable testimony	FACT: Many puruṣas	FACT: Puruṣa changeless; prakṛti evolves	ANALYSIS: Not central like Nyāya universals	FACT: Satkāryavāda; effect pre-exists in cause	FACT: Classical Sāṃkhya non-theistic; Yoga admits Īśvara specially	FACT: Kaivalya of puruṣa from prakṛti
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Multiple pramāṇas including śabda; exact list varies by sub-school	FACT: Enduring self	FACT: World and Veda treated as real	FACT: Realist tendencies	ANALYSIS: Apūrva links ritual action and result	FACT: No creator required for Vedic authority	ANALYSIS: Often cessation of pain / ritual-moral fulfilment depending on account
Advaita	FACT: Six pramāṇas in standard Advaita pedagogy	FACT: Ultimately one ātman-Brahman	FACT: Brahman changeless; world mithyā	ANALYSIS: Ultimately sublated in non-duality	ANALYSIS: Vivarta-style appearance rather than real transformation	ANALYSIS: Īśvara is empirical-soteriological, not ultimate second reality	FACT: Realization of non-duality
Cārvāka	FACT: Perception primarily	FACT: Body-based consciousness	FACT: Material change only	CAUTION: Universals not central as real entities	ANALYSIS: Material causal regularity	FACT: Rejects creator God	FACT: Rejects mokṣa or reduces goal to this-worldly life

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. FACT: Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. FACT: Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. FACT: Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. ANALYSIS: Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

7D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON ANALYSIS:

Western comparison	Point of contact	Disanalogy
Anekāntavāda and Nietzschean perspectivism	ANALYSIS: Both deny a simple “view from nowhere” for ordinary knowers	FACT: Jainism is realist: aspects are in the object; perspectivism is often read anti-realist
Syādvāda and many-valued / paraconsistent logic	ANALYSIS: Seven bhaṅgas resemble non-classical evaluation	FACT: Syāt is a standpoint-operator, not a third truth-value; avaktavya is inexpressibility in one unqualified utterance, not a truth-value gap
Anekānta and Hegelian dialectic	ANALYSIS: Both allow opposites within the real	FACT: Hegelian opposites are sublated into higher synthesis; Jaina aspects coexist without sublation
Ahiṃsā and Schweitzer’s reverence for life	ANALYSIS: Both widen moral concern toward life	FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is grounded in jīva, karma, and liberation, not only ethical reverence
Jaina souls and Leibnizian monads	ANALYSIS: Both are plural centres carrying their own history	FACT: Jaina souls interact with karmic matter and vary in spatial extension; monads do not interact materially in the same way
Material karma and mechanistic psychology	ANALYSIS: Both seek causal explanation for conduct and character	FACT: Jaina karma is subtle moral matter tied to liberation, not value-neutral brain mechanism

Rubric. ANALYSIS: Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

7E. DIRECTIVE DECODER ANALYSIS:

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Jainism answer	Closing verdict
Discuss	FACT: Breadth plus coherence	Define doctrine -> explain mechanics -> add one debate	ANALYSIS: "Thus Jainism offers a coherent pluralist realism, though its metaphysical costs remain."
Examine	FACT: Doctrinal accuracy	Break into components: dravya, naya, syāt, karma, mokṣa	ANALYSIS: "The doctrine is intelligible when its presuppositions are made explicit."
Critically examine	FACT: Doctrine plus objections	Present Śaṃkara/Nyāya/Buddhist objections and Jaina replies	ANALYSIS: "The reply is strong internally but not neutral across all schools."
Analyse	FACT: Internal logic	Show cause-effect links: metaphysics -> epistemology -> language -> liberation	ANALYSIS: "Its strength lies in systematic interconnection."
Evaluate	FACT: Balanced judgement	State strengths, weaknesses, and residual contestation	ANALYSIS: "Persuasive as qualified realism; vulnerable on material karma and omniscience."
Compare	FACT: Inter-school positioning	Use axes: self, causation, pramāṇa, karma, mokṣa	ANALYSIS: "The comparison shows Jainism as a middle path between flux and static permanence."
Distinguish	FACT: Conceptual precision	Use tables: anekānta/syādvāda/saptabhaṅgī; bhāva/dravya bandha	ANALYSIS: "The distinction prevents common UPSC connotations."
Elucidate	FACT: Clear explanation with examples	Define -> give example -> link to soteriology	ANALYSIS: "The example reveals the doctrinal logic, not merely illustration."
Comment	FACT: Short evaluative insight	State thesis and one philosophical implication	ANALYSIS: "The comment should be pointed, not a full survey."
Bring out	FACT: Hidden relation	Show how reality is reflected in judgement or karma in liberation	ANALYSIS: "The relation is constitutive, not accidental."
Do you agree?	FACT: Reasoned stance	Agree partly -> give doctrine -> objections -> qualified verdict	ANALYSIS: "Agree within Jaina presuppositions; qualify from rival standpoints."

7F. GRADED VERDICT ON JAINISM ANALYSIS:

Strong FACT:

1. FACT: Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.
2. FACT: Anekāntavāda, nayavāda, and syādvāda form a disciplined sequence from ontology to epistemology to language.
3. FACT: Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.
4. FACT: Its ahimsā follows directly from plural jīvas and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

Weak ANALYSIS:

1. ANALYSIS: Material karma binding a conscious soul remains difficult for non-Jaina metaphysics.
2. ANALYSIS: Omniscience and higher direct knowledges are hard to verify externally.
3. ANALYSIS: The system can seem over-taxonomic in karma-types, guṇasthānas, and nayas.
4. ANALYSIS: Reflexively qualified syādvāda may appear to weaken its own universal claim.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

1. CAUTION: Sectarian nuances about kāla's substantial independence differ in presentation.
2. CAUTION: Modern legal-ethical evaluation of sallekhanā requires case-specific verification before citing details.
3. CAUTION: Historical dating of several Jaina thinkers should not be asserted unless separately verified.

Ready verdicts. ANALYSIS:

- **10 marks:** Jainism is a pluralistic realism that avoids both pure permanence and pure flux by making every real a unity of dravya and paryāya.
- **15 marks:** Its genius lies in connecting many-sided reality with conditional judgement, but its material karma and omniscience doctrines remain philosophically contestable.
- **20 marks:** Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism: internally systematic, ethically powerful, and logically subtle, though vulnerable to external critiques of contradiction, soul-matter interaction, and unverifiable higher knowledge.

8. PYQ ROUTING (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 9 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.
2019	Q6(a)	20 marks	How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.
2020	Q5(a)	10 marks	Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?
2021	Q7(c)	15 marks	Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) 'Naya'.
2022	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.
2022	Q6(b)	15 marks	'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.
2023	Q5(a)	10 marks	"All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya) in the light of above statement.
2024	Q6(c)	15 marks	What is the distinction between Bhāva-bandha and Dravya-bandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.
2025	Q7(c)	15 marks	Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

9. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks) ANALYSIS:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Final verdict: Jaina philosophy combines metaphysical pluralism, perspectival logic and ethical self-purification, but its coherence depends on showing that conditional predication preserves truth without collapsing into contradiction or relativism.

9.1 10-mark answer

Define the key term precisely: anekāntavāda, syādvāda, karma, or bhāva-bandha.
Give the doctrinal core in 3-4 compact points.
Add one distinction that prevents confusion (e.g., anekāntavāda vs syādvāda).
Close with one evaluative line or exam-relevant implication.

9.2 15-mark answer

Frame the issue: Jainism balances realism with non-absolutism.
Body A: explain the doctrine requested (reality / sevenfold judgement / bondage).
Body B: add structure-tables, ordered seven predicates, or bondage sequence.
Body C: include one criticism and one reply.
Conclude with a clear philosophical verdict, not mere summary.

9.3 20-mark answer

Open by linking metaphysics and judgement: many-sided reality requires qualified predication.

Section 1: define reality via dravya, guṇa, paryāya, utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya.

Section 2: show reflection in nayavāda, syādvāda, saptabhaṅgi.

Section 3: if asked, connect to soul, karma, and liberation.

Section 4: critically assess pluralism, realism, and self-refutation objections.

End with a balanced conclusion: realism without dogmatism.

10. LINK-OUTS

- Carvaka.md
- Buddhism.md
- Vedanta.md
- Pramāṇa across schools
- Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique
- Indian Philosophy PYQ bank, 2018-2025

SOURCES

- *Tattvārthasūtra* / *Tattvārthadhigama-sūtra* (named without invented sūtra numbers).
- Chatterjee & Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The complete 2018-2025 route contains **nine verified topic-owned questions**. Match each question to its centre of gravity:

- Reality and judgement: 2019.
- Karma and liberation: 2020 and 2022.
- Sevenfold judgement: 2021 and 2023.
- Absolutism objection: 2022.
- Bound/liberated soul and bondage: 2018 and 2024.
- Pluralism and realism: 2025.

Use the answer architectures and directive decoder in the retained source material below. The full model solutions, MCQs and original practice follow immediately after the layered teaching.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall - final master matrix

Prompt	Recall spine
Reality	<i>utpāda + vyaya + dhrauvya</i>
Ontology	six <i>dravyas</i> ; five <i>astikāyas</i> plus time
Logic	<i>anekānta</i> -> <i>naya</i> -> <i>syāt</i> -> seven <i>bhaṅgas</i>
Bondage	passion -> <i>bhāvabandha</i> -> <i>dravyabandha</i>
Release	<i>āsrava</i> -> <i>bandha</i> -> <i>saṃvara</i> -> <i>nirjarā</i> -> <i>mokṣa</i>
Path	right vision + right knowledge + right conduct
Verdict	pluralistic realism with qualified predication

Complete the integrated and remedial MCQs in the practice section before using the final consolidated register notes.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES

START / CONCEPT: NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAIN REPLIES

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Named Criticisms · Jain Replies · dravya · kṣetra · kāla · bhāva

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The operative mechanism is that jaina reply. FACT: FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Jaina reply. FACT: The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same dravya persists while paryāyas arise and cease, so the opposition is between aspects, not within one unqualified predication.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the interaction of conscious pradeśa-bearing jīva and matter remains a debated point.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Jaina reply. FACT: FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: dravya (substance), kṣetra (place), kāla (time), and bhāva (mode). FACT: There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode. FACT: Syādvāda is itself asserted syāt; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule. ANALYSIS: A residual objection remains: if syādvāda is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice protocol - [CORE ANSWER]

Attempt each item before reading its key. Answer placement is balanced, deterministic and non-patterned using a stable topic seed. across all forty-eight diagnostics.

CORE DIAGNOSTIC MCQS

1. Which statement most accurately identifies the place of the Tattvārthasūtra in Jaina philosophy?

A. It is a Śvetāmbara canonical Āgama rejected by all Digambaras. B. It is chiefly a biography of Mahāvīra with no systematic metaphysics. C. It is a systematic Sanskrit exposition attributed to Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī and accepted as authoritative by both major sects. D. It establishes a creator God as the source of karma.

Answer: C. It is a systematic Sanskrit exposition attributed to Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī and accepted as authoritative by both major sects.

The text supplies a shared doctrinal grammar for knowledge, reality, karma and liberation despite sectarian differences elsewhere. It presents the ratnatraya and major metaphysical categories. Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers, not creator Gods.

2. Which is a real dravya but not an astikāya?

A. Ākāśa B. Dharma C. Kāla D. Jīva

Answer: C. Kāla.

Jainism recognises six dravyas but only five astikāyas. Jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma and ākāśa possess extension through many pradeśas; kāla accounts for succession and change but is not an astikāya.

3. In the formula utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya-yuktaṃ sat, the real is characterised by:

A. origination, decay and persistence together. B. creation, preservation and destruction by God. C. substance, universal and inherence. D. momentary arising without an enduring aspect.

Answer: A. Origination, decay and persistence together.

Jaina realism preserves both identity and change. A mode originates and another ceases while the dravya persists. The formula therefore resists both pure flux and an absolutely changeless reality.

4. Which option correctly states the relation among dravya, guṇa and paryāya?

A. Dravya is substance, guṇas are abiding qualities, and paryāyas are changing modes. B. Dravya is unreal, while guṇas alone exist. C. Guṇa and paryāya are interchangeable names for momentary events. D. Paryāya is permanent, while dravya arises and ceases.

Answer: A. Dravya is substance, guṇas are abiding qualities, and paryāyas are changing modes.

The distinction explains permanence-in-change. Qualities belong to a substance as characteristic features, while modes are its variable manifestations. Jaina anekāntavāda depends on this structured complexity.

5. Which list contains exactly the five astikāyas?

A. Jīva, pudgala, ākāśa, kāla and mokṣa B. Pudgala, kāla, puṇya, pāpa and ākāśa C. Jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha and mokṣa D. Jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma and ākāśa

Answer: D. Jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma and ākāśa.

These five are extended substances. Kāla completes the six-dravya scheme but not the pañcāstikāya scheme. The remaining distractors mix ontological substances with soteriological categories.

6. Dharma-dravya and adharma-dravya respectively mean:

A. activity and cessation of activity. B. right conduct and wrong conduct. C. media enabling motion and rest. D. moral merit and moral demerit.

Answer: C. Media enabling motion and rest.

They are enabling conditions, not forces that push or stop objects and not ethical merit or sin. The moral reading is a standard factual trap produced by the ordinary meanings of *dharma* and *adharma*.

7. Which statement best expresses the Jaina conception of jīva?

A. It is a temporary bundle of five aggregates. B. It is an individual conscious substance whose intrinsic capacities are obscured by karma. C. It is ultimately identical with one universal Brahman. D. It is a property generated by a sufficiently organised body.

Answer: B. It is an individual conscious substance whose intrinsic capacities are obscured by karma.

Jainism affirms infinitely many beginningless jīvas. Consciousness is intrinsic, not adventitious. Bondage obscures infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power without destroying the soul's numerical identity.

8. Which feature uniquely marks pudgala among the six dravyas?

A. It alone possesses rūpa and includes karmic matter. B. It alone is not real. C. It alone is conscious. D. It alone enables motion.

Answer: A. It alone possesses rūpa and includes karmic matter.

Pudgala is material, form-bearing, divisible and aggregative. Bodies, sense-objects and subtle karma-pudgala belong to it. This makes Jaina bondage literally psychophysical rather than merely metaphorical.

9. In the strict Jaina epistemological classification, ordinary sensory cognition is:

A. mediated cognition, though conventionally called empirical pratyakṣa. B. identical with kevala-jñāna. C. rejected as intrinsically false. D. the highest form of unmediated pratyakṣa.

Answer: A. Mediated cognition, though conventionally called empirical pratyakṣa.

Strict directness is freedom from sense-and-mind mediation. Ordinary seeing is *sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa* in practical usage but falls under mediated mati-jñāna in the higher classification. This is the Jaina "pratyakṣa inversion."

10. Which pair is correctly classified as parokṣa in the basic five-jñāna scheme?

A. Avadhi and manaḥparyāya B. Śruta and kevala C. Mati and śruta D. Mati and avadhi

Answer: C. Mati and śruta.

Mati depends on senses and mind; śruta depends on signs, language and prior cognition. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are direct in the strict sense because they transcend ordinary sensory-mental mediation.

11. Which is the correct ascending sequence of the five kinds of Jaina knowledge?

- A. Śruta, mati, kevala, avadhi, manaḥparyāya B. Mati, avadhi, śruta, kevala, manaḥparyāya C. Avadhi, mati, manaḥparyāya, śruta, kevala D. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala

Answer: D. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala.

The sequence runs from ordinary sensory-mental cognition and verbal knowledge to limited clairvoyance, direct knowledge of others' mental modes and finally unlimited omniscience. It maps progressive removal of cognitive obstruction.

12. Which statement about Jaina pratyakṣa is correct?

- A. All five jñānas are equally direct. B. Kevala is indirect because it lacks sense-contact. C. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are strict or pāramārthika pratyakṣa. D. Only sense-contact can generate direct knowledge.

Answer: C. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are strict or pāramārthika pratyakṣa.

The Jaina criterion is unmediated manifestation of the soul's cognition, not Nyāya-style sense-object contact. Avadhi and manaḥparyāya remain limited; only kevala-jñāna is unlimited.

13. Anekāntavāda is primarily the doctrine that:

- A. reality is an indescribable illusion. B. every belief is equally true because truth is subjective. C. reality is objectively many-sided and no finite unqualified proposition exhausts it. D. only linguistic differences generate plurality.

Answer: C. Reality is objectively many-sided and no finite unqualified proposition exhausts it.

Anekāntavāda is first a metaphysical thesis, not a slogan of tolerance or scepticism. Multiple aspects belong to the object; finite cognition apprehends them partially. This objective basis separates Jaina perspectivism from subjectivism.

14. Nayavāda explains:

- A. how partial standpoints can yield conditioned truths. B. the five ascetic vows. C. seven ontological substances. D. the destruction of eight karmas.

Answer: A. How partial standpoints can yield conditioned truths.

A naya selects an aspect of a many-sided real. Partiality is not falsehood; error arises when a partial standpoint claims exhaustive status. Nayavāda is thus epistemic, whereas anekāntavāda is ontological.

15. Syādvāda is best described as:

- A. the denial that propositions can be true. B. the taxonomy of seven epistemic standpoints. C. the doctrine that only omniscience is knowledge. D. conditional predication through the operator *syāt*.

Answer: D. Conditional predication through the operator *syāt*.

Syāt means "in some respect" or "from a certain standpoint." It makes language register the conditions under which a proposition is true and prevents a finite assertion from becoming ekāntic or one-sided.

16. Which formula correctly distinguishes the three doctrines?

- A. Anekāntavāda = language; nayavāda = matter; syādvāda = liberation. B. Anekāntavāda = many-sided reality; nayavāda = standpoint-theory; syādvāda = qualified assertion. C. Anekāntavāda = scepticism; nayavāda = omniscience; syādvāda = ethics. D. Anekāntavāda = seven predicates; nayavāda = seven tattvas; syādvāda = seven vows.

Answer: B. Anekāntavāda = many-sided reality; nayavāda = standpoint-theory; syādvāda = qualified assertion.

The doctrines form a dependence chain rather than synonyms. Ontological complexity limits finite cognition to standpoints, and standpoint-conditioned cognition requires qualified language.

17. Which is the correct first member of the seven nayas?

- A. Evambhūta naya B. R̥jusūtra naya C. Śabda naya D. Naigama naya

Answer: D. Naigama naya.

The seven nayas are naigama, saṃgraha, vyavahāra, rjusūtra, śabda, samabhirūḍha and evambhūta. Naigama is the common, purposive or unspecialised practical standpoint.

18. Which option correctly pairs a naya with its characteristic emphasis?

A. Saṃgraha-only the present moment B. Evambhūta-generic class-character C. Rjusūtra-the present-state or momentary standpoint D. Vyavahāra-strict etymological derivation

Answer: C. Rjusūtra-the present-state or momentary standpoint.

Saṃgraha stresses generic class-character; vyavahāra concerns practical particulars; samabhirūḍha is etymologically discriminating; evambhūta applies a word when its relevant function is actually being performed.

19. Which statement correctly distinguishes seven nayas from seven bhingas?

A. Nayas are karmic stages; bhingas are forms of knowledge. B. Nayas apply only to monks, whereas bhingas apply only to householders. C. Nayas classify standpoints, whereas bhingas classify conditioned predicational forms. D. Both are identical enumerations with different spellings.

Answer: C. Nayas classify standpoints, whereas bhingas classify conditioned predicational forms.

The seven nayas concern ways of approaching an object-generic, practical, temporal and linguistic. The seven bhingas are combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under *syāt*.

20. What is the correct fourth bhanga?

A. *syād nāsti* B. *syād avaktavyam* C. *syād asti ca avaktavyam* D. *syād asti ca nāsti ca*

Answer: B. syād avaktavyam.

The sequence begins affirmation, negation, both, and then inexpressibility. The fifth, sixth and seventh combine *avaktavya* respectively with affirmation, negation, and both.

21. In saptabhaṅgī, avaktavya chiefly signifies:

A. the inability of one simple unqualified utterance to express complex indexed aspects simultaneously. B. that the object is absolutely unknowable. C. that silence itself causes liberation. D. that every proposition is meaningless.

Answer: A. The inability of one simple unqualified utterance to express complex indexed aspects simultaneously.

Inexpressibility is semantic-modal, not nihilistic or merely psychological. A thing can be knowable under distinct aspects even when their temporally or modally complex conjunction cannot be stated in one simple assertion.

22. “In some respect, the jar is and is not” avoids formal contradiction if:

A. both predicates are asserted without qualification at the same time. B. affirmation and negation are indexed to different respects, times, places or modes. C. the jar is treated as imaginary. D. one of the two predicates is secretly false.

Answer: B. Affirmation and negation are indexed to different respects, times, places or modes.

The law of non-contradiction forbids P and not-P of the same subject in the same respect and time. Jaina predication deliberately changes the index; suppressing the index produces the caricature of contradiction.

23. The standard self-refutation objection to anekāntavāda argues that:

A. many-sided objects cannot have qualities. B. karma cannot explain rebirth. C. if all claims are qualified, anekāntavāda must either qualify itself or violate its own rule. D. only a creator God can know all sides.

Answer: C. If all claims are qualified, anekāntavāda must either qualify itself or violate its own rule.

If unqualified, the doctrine appears absolutist; if qualified, critics say it loses universal force. The Jaina reply is reflexive qualification: the doctrine rejects finite one-sided exhaustiveness, not objective truth or graded comprehensiveness.

24. Which is the strongest Jaina reply to the claim that non-absolutism necessarily presupposes crude absolutism?

A. No proposition has any truth. B. Finite judgements are standpoint-bound, while kevala-jñāna represents comprehensive cognition. C. Contradictions are always acceptable. D. Every standpoint is equally complete.

Answer: B. Finite judgements are standpoint-bound, while kevala-jñāna represents comprehensive cognition.

Jainism distinguishes epistemic levels. It can affirm the objective many-sidedness of reality while denying that an ordinary unqualified claim exhausts it. The residual burden is independently supporting omniscience rather than merely postulating it to rescue the theory.

25. Which statement best captures Jaina karma?

A. It is only the memory of previous actions. B. It is subtle material pudgala that binds the passion-affected soul. C. It is identical with Mīmāṃsā apūrva. D. It is divine reward and punishment.

Answer: B. It is subtle material pudgala that binds the passion-affected soul.

Jaina karma is literally material, though extremely subtle. Psychic states attract and fix it to jīva. This differs from an unseen moral potency, a mere psychological disposition or a divine ledger.

26. Which pair correctly distinguishes the two forms of bondage?

A. Bhāvabandha is bodily bondage; dravyabandha is verbal error. B. Bhāvabandha is liberation; dravyabandha is omniscience. C. Bhāvabandha stops karma; dravyabandha sheds it. D. Bhāvabandha is psychic passion and delusion; dravyabandha is material karmic adhesion.

Answer: D. Bhāvabandha is psychic passion and delusion; dravyabandha is material karmic adhesion.

Bhāvabandha is the internal causal condition that makes the soul adhesive. Dravyabandha is the objective karmic result. The distinction joins moral psychology to a realist material mechanism.

27. Which set gives the four parameters of bandha?

A. Jīva, ajīva, puṇya and pāpa B. Prakṛti, sthiti, anubhāga and pradeśa C. Darśana, jñāna, cāritra and tapas D. Āsrava, bandha, nirjarā and mokṣa

Answer: B. Prakṛti, sthiti, anubhāga and pradeśa.

They denote the type, duration, intensity and quantity of karmic bondage. Yoga chiefly determines type and quantity; kaṣāya chiefly determines duration and intensity.

28. Which pairing of bondage parameter and principal determinant is correct?

A. Prakṛti-kevala-jñāna; anubhāga-mokṣa B. Sthiti-yoga only; prakṛti-kaṣāya only C. Sthiti-ākāśa; pradeśa-kāla D. Prakṛti and pradeśa-yoga; sthiti and anubhāga-kaṣāya

Answer: D. Prakṛti and pradeśa-yoga; sthiti and anubhāga-kaṣāya.

Activity brings karmic matter into relation with the soul and affects its type and amount. Passions make bondage durable and intense. Hence intention and affect modify the karmic consequence of outwardly similar actions.

29. Which list gives the seven tattvas?

A. Jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā and mokṣa B. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala, puṇya and pāpa C. Ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, aparigraha, tapas and mokṣa D. Jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla and mokṣa

Answer: A. Jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā and mokṣa.

The list moves from the conscious and non-conscious poles to influx, binding, prevention, shedding and release. It is ontology organised for liberation rather than a neutral inventory.

30. The nine padārthas are:

A. the five astikāyas plus four vows. B. the seven tattvas plus dharma and adharma. C. the six dravyas plus the three jewels. D. the seven tattvas plus puṇya and pāpa.

Answer: D. The seven tattvas plus puṇya and pāpa.

The ninefold list makes moral valence explicit. Yet puṇya, though preferable to pāpa within saṃsāra, still involves karma and is not identical with mokṣa.

31. Which sequence correctly states the operational path from bondage to liberation?

A. Bandha -> mokṣa -> āsrava -> saṃvara -> nirjarā B. Āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa C. Saṃvara -> āsrava -> bandha -> mokṣa -> nirjarā D. Nirjarā -> bandha -> āsrava -> mokṣa -> saṃvara

Answer: B. Āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa.

Āsrava is influx and bandha is attachment. Saṃvara prevents new karmic inflow, while nirjarā removes accumulated karma. Mokṣa follows only when karmic bondage is completely absent.

32. Which statement correctly distinguishes saṃvara and nirjarā?

A. Saṃvara is influx; nirjarā is adhesion. B. Saṃvara destroys the soul; nirjarā creates a new soul. C. Saṃvara produces merit; nirjarā produces demerit. D. Saṃvara stops new karma, whereas nirjarā sheds karma already bound.

Answer: D. Saṃvara stops new karma, whereas nirjarā sheds karma already bound.

The distinction expresses the preventive and purgative dimensions of Jaina practice. Closing an inlet does not remove sediment already deposited; both operations are required for liberation.

33. Which set contains only ghātiyā karmas?

A. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohaniya and antarāya B. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus C. Mohanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus D. Jñānāvaraṇīya, vedanīya, nāma and gotra

Answer: A. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohaniya and antarāya.

These obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation/conduct and energy. They damage or veil the soul's essential capacities. Mohanīya is especially dangerous because delusion corrupts both vision and conduct.

34. Which set contains only aghātiyā karmas?

A. Nāma, gotra, jñānāvaraṇīya and darśanāvaraṇīya B. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus C. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohaniya and antarāya D. Vedanīya, mohaniya, antarāya and āyus

Answer: B. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus.

They determine pleasure-pain, embodiment, status and lifespan without directly obscuring the soul's essential knowledge, perception, orientation and power. They remain after ghātiyā karmas are destroyed in the sayoga-kevalī.

35. Which stage correctly describes the sayoga-kevalī?

A. A soul with false vision and no restraint B. An embodied omniscient arhat with activity and residual aghātiyā karmas C. A liberated bodiless siddha beyond all activity D. A householder observing only partial vows

Answer: B. An embodied omniscient arhat with activity and residual aghātiyā karmas.

Sayoga-kevalī is the thirteenth guṇasthāna. Ghātiyā karmas are destroyed, so omniscience manifests, but bodily, verbal and mental activity continues until the remaining embodiment-determining karmas approach exhaustion.

36. Ayoga-kevalī is:

A. the final, momentary omniscient stage without activity immediately before siddhahood. B. the first stage of wrong vision. C. the stage where subtle greed alone remains. D. a condition of suppressed but undestroyed delusion.

Answer: A. The final, momentary omniscient stage without activity immediately before siddhahood.

It is the fourteenth guṇasthāna. All yoga ceases; the remaining aghātiyā karmas are exhausted, after which the soul becomes a bodiless siddha. It should not be confused with final liberation itself.

37. The ratnatraya consists of:

A. Ahimsā, satya and aparigraha B. Āsrava, saṃvara and nirjarā C. Samyag-darśana, samyag-jñāna and samyak-cāritra D. Matī, śruta and kevala

Answer: C. Samyag-darśana, samyag-jñāna and samyak-cāritra.

Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct are mutually reinforcing dimensions of the path. Knowledge without conduct cannot halt karmic inflow, while conduct without right orientation lacks soteriological direction.

38. Which is not one of the five mahāvratas?

A. Īśvara-praṇidhāna B. Aparigraha C. Ahimsā D. Asteya

Answer: A. Īśvara-praṇidhāna.

The five are ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacharya and aparigraha. Devotion to a creator Lord is not included; Jainism is non-theistic regarding cosmic creation.

39. Which statement best explains “liberation by subtraction” in Jainism?

A. Removal of karmic obstruction manifests the soul's intrinsic infinite capacities. B. Mokṣa creates consciousness in a previously unconscious soul. C. Liberation adds divine grace to an incomplete jīva. D. The soul is subtracted from existence.

Answer: A. Removal of karmic obstruction manifests the soul's intrinsic infinite capacities.

Kevala-jñāna and the ananta-catuṣṭaya are revealed rather than manufactured. Purification radically changes the soul's modes while preserving the numerical identity of the dravya.

40. Which is the most defensible overall classification of Jaina philosophy?

A. Subjective idealism with ethical conventionalism B. Absolute monism with an illusory world C. Nihilism combined with linguistic scepticism D. Pluralistic realism combined with epistemic non-absolutism

Answer: D. Pluralistic realism combined with epistemic non-absolutism.

Jainism affirms many independent substances, many souls and a mind-independent world. Finite knowledge is standpoint-conditioned, but the object is not made unreal by that limitation. This formulation also fits the 2025 “pluralistic and realistic” directive.

REMEDIAL DIAGNOSTIC MCQS

41. Which statement about sallekhanā is doctrinally safest?

A. It is a carefully regulated, passionless thinning of body and attachment at an appropriate end of life, not impulsive suicide. B. It is mandatory self-killing for every lay follower. C. It aims to destroy the soul along with the body. D. It is a sacrifice offered to a creator God.

Answer: A. It is a carefully regulated, passionless thinning of body and attachment at an appropriate end of life, not impulsive suicide.

The decisive factors are intention, terminal context, equanimity and absence of passion. It must not be romanticised or treated as an ordinary escape from distress; its doctrinal defence rests on non-attachment and karmic purification.

42. Śaṅkara's central criticism of anekāntavāda is that:

A. liberation cannot preserve individuality. B. Jainism accepts too few substances. C. opposed predicates threaten contradiction and the doctrine faces a self-reference dilemma. D. material karma requires a creator God.

Answer: C. Opposed predicates threaten contradiction and the doctrine faces a self-reference dilemma.

Śaṅkara presses both logical consistency and assertoric force: if anekāntavāda is absolute, it violates itself; if merely conditional, it may fail to govern discourse. Jainism replies through indexed predicates and reflexive qualification.

43. Which named criticism-reply pair is correctly matched?

A. Nyāya: all objects are empty; reply: dependent origination B. Dharmakīrti/Buddhist: a permanent-yet-changing soul faces the causal-efficacy dilemma; reply: permanence as dravya and change as paryāya C. Rāmānuja: no object has qualities; reply: momentariness D. Cārvāka: a permanent soul cannot act; reply: apūrva

Answer: B. Dharmakīrti/Buddhist: a permanent-yet-changing soul faces the causal-efficacy dilemma; reply: permanence as dravya and change as paryāya.

The Jaina response invokes *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*. Its force depends on accepting a real substance-mode distinction; a Buddhist who denies enduring substance will remain unconvinced.

44. What is the strongest residual philosophical difficulty in the doctrine of material karma?

A. It makes ethical conduct irrelevant. B. It cannot distinguish good and bad actions. C. It requires an eternal creator. D. The interaction between conscious jīva and material karma-pudgala remains obscure.

Answer: D. The interaction between conscious jīva and material karma-pudgala remains obscure.

Jainism invokes the jīva's pradeśas, embodiment and passion-generated adhesiveness, but critics argue that the causal bridge still requires explanation. A strong answer should present the internal mechanism and preserve this residual objection.

45. In a PYQ asking “How does karma bear upon soteriology?”, which answer-plan best follows the directive?

A. Narrate Mahāvīra's life and list pilgrimage centres. B. Discuss only the seven nayas and omit liberation. C. Compare every Indian school without explaining Jaina karma. D. Define material karma, trace āsrava-bandha-saṃvara-nirjarā-mokṣa, connect practices to each stage, then evaluate the mechanism.

Answer: D. Define material karma, trace āsrava-bandha-saṃvara-nirjarā-mokṣa, connect practices to each stage, then evaluate the mechanism.

“Bear upon” tests causal dependence, not independent notes on karma and mokṣa. The answer must show how the ontology of karmic matter determines both the disciplines of prevention/shedding and the final condition of the soul.

46. Which statement is a factual trap?

A. Both puṇya and pāpa involve karmic determination. B. Puṇya is identical with mokṣa because all good karma liberates permanently. C. Puṇya may improve one's saṃsāric condition. D. Puṇya and pāpa are added to seven tattvas in the nine-padārtha list.

Answer: B. Puṇya is identical with mokṣa because all good karma liberates permanently.

Merit is preferable to demerit but remains karmic involvement and can yield favourable rebirth rather than final release. Mokṣa requires transcendence of all karma, pleasant as well as painful.

47. Which statement about the fourteen guṇasthānas is correct?

A. Every stage is attained at the instant of right vision. B. They are seven linguistic standpoints doubled. C. They mark graded purification from mithyā-dṛṣṭi through sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī toward liberation. D. They describe cosmological substances rather than spiritual development.

Answer: C. They mark graded purification from mithyā-dṛṣṭi through sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī toward liberation.

The scheme makes spiritual progress gradual and karmically analysable. Delusion may be suppressed at stage eleven and destroyed at stage twelve; omniscience with activity appears at thirteen and without activity at fourteen.

48. Which concluding sentence best answers “Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss”?

A. Jainism is relativist, so it denies every objective object. B. Jainism is monistic because all liberated souls merge. C. Jainism is realistic only about matter, not souls or modes. D. Jainism is pluralistic realism with standpoint-conditioned finite knowledge, though substance-mode unity and omniscience remain contested.

Answer: D. Jainism is pluralistic realism with standpoint-conditioned finite knowledge, though substance-mode unity and omniscience remain contested.

The sentence answers both classificatory terms, distinguishes ontology from epistemology and preserves a critical remainder. It avoids the false inference that qualified judgement entails idealism or scepticism.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQS - 9 COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

The following are independent practice models prepared from the verified question corpus and Jaina doctrine. They are not official UPSC answer keys.

2018 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Explain the mechanism of bondage, not merely define karma.
- Compare the bound and liberated soul on identity, embodiment, cognition and destiny.
- State positively what remains after liberation.

- “Discuss” requires one conceptual difficulty and a balanced conclusion.

Independent model answer

Jainism explains bondage as the beginningless but terminable association of conscious **jīva** with subtle material **karma-pudgala**. The soul is intrinsically capable of infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, yet activity of body, speech and mind (**yoga**), when coloured by delusion and the passions of anger, pride, deceit and greed, attracts karmic matter.

Bondage has two inseparable dimensions. **Bhāvabandha** is psychic bondage: the soul’s wrong vision, attachment, aversion and passion make it “adhesive.” **Dravyabandha** is the consequent material attachment of karmic particles. The process may be mapped as **āsrava** (influx) -> **bandha** (adhesion). Its reversal requires **saṃvara**, which stops fresh influx, and **nirjarā**, which sheds accumulated karma.

Bound soul	Liberated soul
Embodied and co-extensive with its body	Bodiless siddha
Knowledge and perception obscured	Kevala-jñāna and perfect perception manifest
Subject to pleasure, pain, birth and death	Beyond suffering and rebirth
Conditioned by all eight karma-prakṛtis	Entirely free from karmic matter
Moves through saṃsāra	Abides at siddha-śīlā

The liberated soul does not merge into Brahman and is not annihilated. It retains numerical individuality while manifesting the **ananta-catuṣṭaya**-infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power. Liberation is thus purification of an enduring individual, achieved through the ratnatraya of right vision, right knowledge and right conduct.

The theory preserves moral agency and personal continuity without a creator God. Its residual difficulty is explaining how conscious jīva and material karma interact. Nevertheless, within Jaina pluralistic realism, bondage is a real psychophysical entanglement and mokṣa its complete removal.

Why this earns marks

- Answers all three limbs of the question in separate, connected moves.
- Distinguishes bhāvabandha from dravyabandha instead of treating bondage generically.
- Uses the complete āsrava-bandha-saṃvara-nirjarā route.
- Compares bound and liberated souls across five examinable dimensions.
- Avoids the Advaita trap of merger and the Buddhist trap of self-extinction.
- Adds a precise interaction objection without displacing doctrinal exposition.

2019 · Q6(a) · 20 marks

Question: How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss. Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Define reality through the Jaina formula of permanence-in-change.
- Explain dravya, guṇa, paryāya and anekāntavāda.
- Derive nayavāda, syādvāda and saptabhaṅgī from that ontology.
- “Discuss” requires illustration, criticism, reply and a qualified verdict.

Independent model answer

Jainism defines the real as that which possesses **utpāda** (origination), **vyaya** (decay) and **dhrauvya** (persistence): **utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktaṃ sat**. Pure permanence cannot explain experienced change, while pure flux cannot explain identity. A real therefore persists as **dravya**, possesses abiding **guṇas**, and changes through **paryāyas**.

This ontology is irreducibly plural. The six dravyas are jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa and kāla. Five are astikāyas; kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya. A gold ornament illustrates the formula: gold persists, bracelet-mode ceases and ring-mode originates. Because every real contains multiple objective aspects, reality is **anekānta**,

non-one-sided.

The theory of judgement follows from this metaphysics. Finite knowers normally apprehend an object under a partial **naya** or standpoint. A naya is not false merely because partial; it becomes false when absolutised. **Syādvāda** therefore requires the operator *syāt*-"in some respect"-so that language records the conditions of truth. Its sevenfold elaboration is:

1. *syād asti*-in some respect it is;
2. *syād nāsti*-in some respect it is not;
3. *syād asti ca nāsti ca*-in different respects it is and is not;
4. *syād avaktavyam*-in some respect it is inexpressible;
5. *syād asti ca avaktavyam*;
6. *syād nāsti ca avaktavyam*;
7. *syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam*.

A jar exists here and now as a jar, does not exist as cloth or as a future destroyed jar, and is *avaktavya* when temporally and modally distinct determinations are demanded in one simple, simultaneous utterance. The scheme does not affirm P and not-P in the same respect, place, time and mode.

Śaṃkara objects that opposed predicates destroy determinate knowledge and that *anekāntavāda* either asserts itself absolutely or loses universal force. The Jaina reply indexes predication to **dravya, kṣetra, kāla and bhāva** and reflexively applies *syāt* to its own doctrine. Moreover, finite judgement is standpoint-bound, whereas *kevala-jñāna* is comprehensive.

Thus Jaina judgement is not scepticism or subjective relativism. It is the linguistic discipline demanded by a pluralistic realism. Its strength is the reconciliation of identity, change and cognitive humility; its burden is independently justifying omniscience and the status of its own universal claims.

Why this earns marks

- Opens with the exact metaphysical formula and explains each term.
- Links *dravya-guṇa-paryāya* to *anekāntavāda* rather than listing doctrines.
- Derives judgement theory through the chain *anekānta* -> *naya* -> *syāt* -> seven *bhāngas*.
- Gives all seven predications in the correct order.
- Uses a worked object-example and the conditions blocking contradiction.
- Engages Śaṃkara and ends with a genuinely critical verdict.

2020 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?

Demand decoding

- Identify what is distinctive about Jaina karma.
- Show its causal relation to bondage and liberation.
- "Examine" requires a compact conceptual assessment, not only description.

Independent model answer

Jainism treats karma not merely as moral law, merit-demerit or unseen potency, but as subtle **material pudgala**. Activity of body, speech and mind produces **āsrava**, while delusion and the four **kaṣāyas**-anger, pride, deceit and greed-make the soul receptive to karmic matter. Its attachment is **bandha**, which obscures the *jīva*'s intrinsic knowledge, perception, energy and bliss.

This material conception directly structures liberation. The *ratnatraya*-right vision, right knowledge and right conduct-together with vows, restraint and austerity weakens passion. **Samvara** prevents fresh influx; **nirjarā** exhausts previously accumulated karma. Destruction of the obscuring karmas manifests *kevala-jñāna*, and destruction of every karmic residue yields *mokṣa*: the individual soul becomes a bodiless *siddha*.

Hence liberation is "by subtraction": perfection is revealed when obstruction is removed, not bestowed by God or produced as a new essence. The doctrine unifies ethics and metaphysics through a precise causal mechanism.

However, the interaction of material karma with conscious jīva remains philosophically obscure, and beginningless bondage explains the absence of a first fall rather than its possibility.

Why this earns marks

- Identifies karma as material pudgala, the central factual discriminator.
- Connects yoga and kaṣāya to influx and adhesion.
- Explains both preventive and purgative sides of liberation.
- Uses the “liberation by subtraction” insight to answer “bear upon.”
- Includes one concise internal strength and one residual objection.

2021 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) ‘Naya’.

Demand decoding

- Clarify the relation among naya, syāt and saptabhaṅgī.
- State all seven predications exactly and in order.
- Explain *avaktavya* and answer the contradiction objection.

Independent model answer

The Jaina sevenfold judgement is the formal expression of a many-sided reality. **Anekāntavāda** is the metaphysical thesis that a real has multiple aspects; **nayavāda** explains that finite cognition approaches it through partial standpoints; **syādvāda** requires each finite assertion to be qualified by *syāt*, “in some respect.” Saptabhaṅgī is therefore not a list of seven nayas but a schema of seven conditioned predications.

1. **syād asti**-in some respect, it is.
2. **syād nāsti**-in some respect, it is not.
3. **syād asti ca nāsti ca**-in different respects or successively, it is and is not.
4. **syād avaktavyam**-in some respect, it is inexpressible.
5. **syād asti ca avaktavyam**-it is and is inexpressible.
6. **syād nāsti ca avaktavyam**-it is not and is inexpressible.
7. **syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam**-it is, is not and is inexpressible.

A jar exists as a present jar at a given place; it does not exist as cloth, elsewhere, or after destruction. It may be called inexpressible where a single unqualified utterance is asked to express jointly what belongs to different times, modes or relations. *Avaktavya* therefore does not mean sheer ignorance or mystical silence; it marks a limitation of simple simultaneous predication.

Critics such as Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja argue that “is” and “is not” threaten non-contradiction. The Jaina reply is that contradiction arises only when opposed predicates attach in the same respect, place, time and mode. *Syāt* expressly prevents that collapse.

Saptabhaṅgī is consequently neither seven truth-values nor unrestricted relativism. It is a discipline for expressing objective but aspect-conditioned truths. Its success depends, however, on making the relevant qualifications explicit rather than using *syāt* as a merely decorative hedge.

Why this earns marks

- Separates the seven standpoints from the seven predication forms.
- Reproduces all seven bhaṅgas accurately and sequentially.
- Gives *avaktavya* a semantic-modal, not mystical, meaning.
- Applies the doctrine to a single coherent example.
- Presents the named contradiction criticism and the indexed Jaina reply.

2022 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

Question: How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Focus on how the karma doctrine determines the path and goal.
- Link material karma to ethical discipline and liberation.
- “Critically discuss” requires a balanced evaluative close.

Independent model answer

Jaina soteriology is unintelligible without its distinctive doctrine of karma as subtle **pudgala**. The jīva is intrinsically capable of infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power, but passion-coloured activity attracts karmic particles that obscure these capacities. Bondage is thus real material accretion, not merely guilt, memory or divine punishment.

The path directly reverses this mechanism: **āsrava** → **bandha** → **saṃvara** → **nirjarā** → **mokṣa**. The three jewels orient the whole person; ahiṃsā, restraint and the vows reduce the activities and passions causing influx; austerity and equanimity shed old karma. When ghātiyā karmas are destroyed, kevala-jñāna manifests in the embodied sayoga-kevalī; after the remaining aghātiyā karmas expire, the soul becomes an unembodied siddha.

The view powerfully integrates moral intention, conduct, cognition and embodiment without invoking creator-God or grace. Yet its literal materialism generates an interaction problem: how does conscious jīva attract and carry karmic matter? Therefore karma gives Jaina soteriology exceptional causal precision, but at a significant metaphysical cost.

Why this earns marks

- Directly answers “bear upon” through a mechanism rather than a definition.
- Correctly distinguishes the kevalin stage from final siddhahood.
- Integrates ratnatraya, vows, saṃvara and nirjarā.
- Shows why the theory works without a creator God.
- Ends with a focused consciousness-matter criticism.

2022 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: ‘The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating ‘Absolutism’.’ Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.

Demand decoding

- Reconstruct the self-reference and universal-scope objection fairly.
- Test whether Jainism is crude relativism or realist non-absolutism.
- Give explicit reasons for a defended conclusion.

Independent model answer

The objection identifies a reflexive difficulty. If every proposition is only relatively true, then “every proposition is relative” is itself relative and cannot govern all judgements. If Jainism asserts anekāntavāda universally, it appears to make an absolute exception for itself. Further, doctrines such as real dravyas, the soul’s intrinsic consciousness and kevala-jñāna seem to claim more than local validity.

This criticism defeats the slogan “all views are equally true,” but that slogan is not classical Jainism. Jainism is a **realist non-absolutism**. Objects possess determinate, objective aspects; a naya is true when it tracks one such aspect and false when its partial truth is absolutised. *Syāt* indexes truth to substance, place, time and mode; it does not turn truth into subjective preference.

Jainism can also distinguish finite and perfect cognition. Ordinary knowledge is karmically limited and therefore aspectual. **Kevala-jñāna**, attained when cognitive obstructions are destroyed, apprehends all aspects. The minimum unconditional commitment is not “nothing is absolute,” but “no finite, unqualified standpoint exhausts a many-sided real.” This proposition can itself be reflexively qualified without becoming meaningless: from the standpoint of finite discourse, non-one-sided predication is rationally required.

Nevertheless, some absoluteness remains. The claim that reality has substance, qualities and modes is universal, while the postulate of omniscience requires independent defence. If invoked solely to guarantee the system, it risks circularity.

Therefore Jaina relativism cannot survive as total relativism; nor need it. The coherent doctrine is qualified pluralistic realism: objective reality, graded cognition and anti-absolutism concerning finite predication. It concedes a minimal framework of truth while rejecting one-sided claims to exhaustive truth.

Why this earns marks

- States the self-reference objection in its strongest logical form.
- Distinguishes relativism, non-absolutism and objective standpoint-truth.
- Explains how kevala-jñāna functions in the Jaina reply.
- Concedes the universal commitments and evidential burden instead of offering a defensive answer.
- Gives clear reasons for a nuanced verdict rather than a binary yes/no.

2023 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: “All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative.” Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya) in the light of above statement.

Demand decoding

- Evaluate, rather than simply accept, the quotation.
- Relate the Jaina classification of knowledge to sevenfold judgement.
- State the scope and limit of saptabhaṅgī concisely.

Independent model answer

Jainism agrees that ordinary embodied cognition is limited, but it does not accept that all knowledge is merely sensory-empirical. In its fivefold classification, **mati** and **śruta** are mediated or parokṣa knowledge. **Avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya** and **kevala** are direct in the strict Jaina sense because they are not mediated by ordinary senses and mind. Thus the proposition in the question is only partially Jaina.

Saptabhaṅgī governs finite discursive judgement. A real combines enduring dravya and changing paryāyas; consequently a jar may be affirmed with respect to its own substance, place, time and mode, negated with respect to another, and called *avaktavya* when these indexed determinations cannot be expressed together in one simple utterance. The seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility prevent a partial judgement from claiming exhaustive truth.

Yet relativity is not universal scepticism. Nayas disclose objective aspects, and kevala-jñāna is held to be complete and non-relative. Critics may regard omniscience as an ad hoc exception; Jainism replies that it follows from removal of knowledge-obscuring karma.

Hence sevenfold judgement is a discipline for finite, conditioned assertion, not proof that every possible cognition is empirical or equally relative.

Why this earns marks

- Challenges the quotation through the Jaina pratyakṣa/parokṣa inversion.
- Correctly classifies all five jñānas.
- Explains the function of sevenfold judgement without wasting space listing all seven.
- Distinguishes objective partial truth from scepticism.
- Adds the precise kevala-jñāna objection and reply.

2024 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is the distinction between Bhāva-bandha and Dravya-bandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Define both forms of bondage with doctrinal precision.
- Explain their causal relation and their place in the liberation sequence.
- “Discuss” warrants the four bandha parameters and one critical issue.

Independent model answer

Jainism distinguishes the soul's psychic condition from the material result produced by it. **Bhāva-bandha** is the bondage constituted by wrong vision, ignorance, attachment, aversion and the four kaṣāyas-anger, pride, deceit and greed. It is a modification of the jīva that makes it receptive or “sticky.” **Dravya-bandha** is the actual association of subtle karma-pudgala with the soul.

The relation is causal:

mithyātva + yoga + kaṣāya → bhāva-bandha → āsrava → dravya-bandha

Yoga, activity of body, speech and mind, brings karmic matter into relation with the soul. Passion fixes it deeply. Material bondage is further analysed through four parameters: **prakṛti** (type), **sthiti** (duration), **anubhāga/rasa** (intensity) and **pradeśa** (quantity). Yoga chiefly determines type and quantity; kaṣāya chiefly determines duration and intensity. Thus identical outward acts can have different karmic consequences according to inner passion.

The distinction also clarifies liberation. Right vision and passionless conduct transform the psychic condition and produce **saṃvara**, stopping new influx. Austerity and equanimity promote **nirjarā**, the shedding of already bound material karma. Inner reform and material purification are therefore mutually necessary.

The theory avoids reducing bondage either to intention alone or to a mechanical physical event. However, it leaves a category-crossing difficulty: the causal bridge by which a conscious modification attracts material particles is asserted more clearly than it is explained.

Why this earns marks

- Defines both terms and avoids reversing psychic cause and material result.
- Supplies a clear causal chain from mithyātva and passion to material adhesion.
- Adds the four parameters of bandha with their determinants.
- Shows how the distinction maps onto saṃvara and nirjarā.
- Gives a balanced assessment of the doctrine's explanatory gain and interaction problem.

2025 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Establish pluralism and realism separately with doctrinal evidence.
- Reconcile objective reality with standpoint-conditioned knowledge.
- Critically discuss objections to permanence-in-change and qualified predication.

Independent model answer

Jaina philosophy is **pluralistic** because it recognises infinitely many individual jīvas and five irreducible kinds of ajīva, together forming six dravyas: jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa and kāla. It rejects both a single universal self and reduction of consciousness to matter. Liberation too preserves a plurality of individual siddhas.

It is **realistic** because substances, qualities and modes exist independently of their being known. The external world is neither mental construction nor ultimately illusory. Each real possesses persistence as dravya and change through paryāya; hence *sat* includes origination, decay and permanence. Anekāntavāda means that the object itself is many-sided, not merely that observers invent different descriptions.

Its epistemology qualifies, rather than abandons, realism. Nayas select objective aspects; syādvāda indexes assertions to respect, place, time and mode; sapta-bhaṅgī systematically combines affirmation, negation and inexpressibility. Truth is perspective-conditioned for finite knowers but not merely subjective.

Three objections remain. Śaṅkara argues that opposed predicates threaten non-contradiction; the Jaina reply separates their respects. A Buddhist critic rejects the enduring substance beneath changing modes; Jainism invokes *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*. The self-refutation objection asks whether anekāntavāda absolutises its own relativity; Jainism reflexively qualifies finite discourse and reserves comprehensive cognition for kevala-jñāna.

Therefore Jainism is best described as **pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism**. Its ontology is robustly objective and irreducibly many; its principal burdens are defending the substance-mode distinction and independently grounding omniscience.

Why this earns marks

- Proves pluralism through many souls, six dravyas and non-merger in liberation.
- Proves realism through mind-independent dravya-guṇa-paryāya.
- Explains why epistemic qualification does not entail ontological idealism.

- Uses three distinct criticisms with their Jaina replies.
- Ends with the most precise classificatory formula and its residual burdens.

ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish *anekāntavāda*, *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, and show why they cannot be treated as synonyms.

Demand decoding

- Define each doctrine at its proper philosophical level.
- Establish their order of dependence.
- Use one example to show their coordinated operation.

Full answer

The three doctrines form a connected architecture, not three names for relativism. **Anekāntavāda** is metaphysical: every real has multiple objective aspects because *dravya* persists while *guṇas* and *paryāyas* provide complex, changing determinations. No finite unqualified proposition exhausts such a real.

Nayavāda is epistemic. A finite knower approaches the many-sided object under a **naya**, a partial standpoint. The substantial standpoint may stress persistence, the modal standpoint change, and practical or linguistic standpoints other features. Partiality is legitimate; only its absolutisation becomes *ekāntavāda*.

Syādvāda is semantic-logical. Since a standpoint yields conditioned truth, assertion should bear *syāt*—"in some respect." This qualification is developed into *saptabhaṅgī*.

A gold bracelet makes the sequence clear. The real includes enduring gold and changing bracelet-mode. One standpoint stresses material continuity, another the produced form. "It exists" is true as this bracelet now; "it does not exist" is true as a ring or after remaking.

Thus ontology grounds standpoint, and standpoint grounds qualified speech. Treating the doctrines as synonyms erases Jainism's movement from reality to knowledge to language.

Why this earns marks

- Defines all three doctrines without conceptual overlap.
- Shows the dependence chain explicitly.
- Uses *dravya* and *paryāya* to ground the explanation.
- Applies one example across all levels.
- Ends by identifying the precise consequence of conflation.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Why is the Jaina classification of *pratyakṣa* described as an "inversion" of ordinary epistemological usage? Examine.

Demand decoding

- State the strict Jaina criterion of directness.
- Classify the five *jñānas* correctly.
- Explain the philosophical function and one objection.

Full answer

Ordinary usage treats sense-perception as paradigmatically direct. Jainism "inverts" this expectation because strict **pratyakṣa** means cognition manifested by the soul without mediation by senses or mind. Seeing a jar is only **sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa**, conventionally direct for practical purposes; doctrinally it belongs to mediated **mati-jñāna**.

The five *jñānas* reflect this criterion. **Mati** and **śruta** are *parokṣa* because they depend respectively on sensory-mental processes and signs or testimony. **Avadhi** is limited direct knowledge of material things beyond ordinary sensory range; **manaḥparyāya** directly grasps others' mental modes; **kevala-jñāna** is unlimited, unmediated omniscience.

The classification links epistemology to soteriology. Directness increases as knowledge-obscuring karma is removed, culminating in the soul's intrinsic cognition. It also explains why ordinary human judgements require nayavāda and syādvāda.

Nyāya may object that knowledge without sense-contact is not perceptual, while the higher jñānas lack ordinary verification. Jainism replies that metaphysical directness concerns absence of mediation, though the empirical objection to extraordinary cognition remains.

Why this earns marks

- Identifies the exact criterion causing the inversion.
- Correctly classifies all five forms of knowledge.
- Links epistemology to karmic purification and conditional judgement.
- Introduces a named Nyāya objection.
- Gives a qualified rather than dogmatic conclusion.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Does saptabhaṅgī violate the law of non-contradiction? Critically examine.

Demand decoding

- State the logical test for contradiction.
- Examine the third and *avaktavya*-bearing bhangas.
- Present the classical objection, Jaina reply and residual condition of success.

Full answer

The law of non-contradiction prohibits asserting P and not-P of the same subject in the same respect, time and sense. Saptabhaṅgī does not intend such an assertion. It combines affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under the operator *syāt*, which indexes every claim to a standpoint.

The first two bhangas-*syād asti* and *syād nāsti*-affirm and deny under different conditions. A jar exists as this jar here and now; it does not exist as cloth, elsewhere, or after destruction. The third-*syād asti ca nāsti ca*-combines these judgements successively or under distinct respects, not as an unqualified simultaneous contradiction.

The fourth, *syād avaktavyam*, marks the inability of one simple utterance to express jointly a complex of differently indexed aspects. It does not mean that the object is unknowable. The remaining bhangas combine *avaktavya* with affirmation, negation, and both.

Śaṃkara and Rāmānuja object that if opposed attributes are genuinely real, shifting the standpoint only relocates rather than solves contradiction. The Jaina response invokes *dravya-paryāya*: permanence belongs to the continuing substance, while origination and cessation belong to modes. The object is complex, but no identical predicate is both affirmed and denied under one index.

A further self-reference problem remains. If every assertion must be qualified, the saptabhaṅgī doctrine itself must be qualified. Jainism can accept this reflexively; it rejects finite one-sided exhaustiveness, not all determinate truth.

Therefore saptabhaṅgī is compatible with non-contradiction when indexes of substance, place, time and mode are explicit. It becomes incoherent only when *syāt* is reduced to a vague verbal hedge or opposed claims are made under the same conditions.

Why this earns marks

- Begins with the formal condition for contradiction.
- Tests the most vulnerable third and fourth predications.
- Explains *avaktavya* with semantic precision.
- Names Śaṃkara and Rāmānuja and supplies the *dravya-paryāya* reply.
- Adds the self-reference issue and a conditional verdict.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Explain how the eight karma-prakṛtis and four parameters of bandha deepen the Jaina account of moral responsibility.

Demand decoding

- Classify all eight karmas and state their functions.
- Explain the four dimensions of karmic binding and their determinants.
- Derive the account of responsibility from intention, passion and activity.

Full answer

Jainism deepens moral responsibility by treating karma as subtle matter whose type and force vary with the agent's activity and passions. The eight **karma-prakṛtis** divide into two groups. The **ghātiyā** karmas are jñānāvaraṇīya, obscuring knowledge; darśanāvaraṇīya, obscuring perception; mohaniya, deluding vision and conduct; and antarāya, obstructing energy. The **aghātiyā** karmas are vedanīya, determining pleasure and pain; nāma, embodiment; gotra, status; and āyus, lifespan.

This taxonomy explains different dimensions of empirical limitation rather than attributing every consequence to an undifferentiated moral force. Mohaniya is especially decisive because delusion misorients both belief and conduct. Destruction of the four ghātiyā karmas yields the omniscient but embodied sayoga-kevalī; the aghātiyā karmas expire only before final siddhahood.

Each act also binds karma under four parameters: **prakṛti** or type, **sthiti** or duration, **anubhāga** or intensity, and **pradeśa** or quantity. Yoga-the activity of body, speech and mind-chiefly determines type and quantity. Kaṣāya-anger, pride, deceit and greed-chiefly determines duration and intensity. Passionless activity therefore has a different karmic result from outwardly similar passion-coloured activity.

The framework joins external conduct to inner agency. It avoids reducing responsibility either to intention alone or to physical movement alone: action brings karma, while passion fixes it. Its strength is causal and ethical granularity. Its weakness is metaphysical elaborateness and the obscure interaction between conscious states and material particles.

Thus Jaina responsibility is neither divine judgement nor mechanical behaviourism. It is a psychophysical account in which what one does and how one inwardly does it jointly shape bondage.

Why this earns marks

- Names and correctly classifies all eight karma-prakṛtis.
- Explains rather than merely lists what each class does.
- Gives all four bandha parameters and their principal determinants.
- Derives a nuanced account of intention and action.
- Connects sayoga-kevalī to the ghātiyā/aghātiyā distinction.
- Balances explanatory richness against metaphysical cost.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Jaina liberation is purification in substance but transformation in mode." Analyse.

Demand decoding

- Interpret both halves through dravya-paryāya ontology.
- Reconstruct bondage, the path, kevala-jñāna and final mokṣa.
- Explain continuity and change in the soul, with criticisms and a reasoned verdict.

Full answer

The statement applies Jaina ontology directly to soteriology. A real combines persistence and change: dravya endures while paryāyas originate and cease. The jīva therefore remains numerically the same substance through bondage and liberation, yet its modes and existential condition are radically transformed.

Purification is "in substance" because liberation does not manufacture a new self or merge many selves into one. Every jīva is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, power and bliss. Empirical ignorance arises because subtle material karma obscures these capacities. Removing karma reveals what belongs to the soul; it does

not replace its identity. In this sense mokṣa is liberation by subtraction.

The process begins with passion-coloured yoga. Wrong vision and kaṣāya constitute bhāvabandha; karmic influx and adhesion constitute dravyabandha. The sequence is **āsrava** -> **bandha** -> **saṃvara** -> **nirjarā** -> **mokṣa**. Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct provide orientation; the vows reduce harmful activity and attachment; austerity and equanimity shed old karma.

Transformation is nevertheless real at the level of modes. The bound jīva is embodied, contracts or expands with its body, undergoes pleasure and pain and moves through rebirth. Progress through the fourteen guṇasthānas gradually removes delusion and passion. At stage thirteen, the sayoga-kevalī has destroyed the ghātiyā karmas and manifests omniscience while residual aghātiyā karmas sustain embodiment. At stage fourteen, activity ceases; after the remaining karma is exhausted, the bodiless siddha abides at siddha-śīlā, beyond rebirth.

The theory thus avoids two extremes. Against Advaita, liberation is not absorption into an undifferentiated absolute. Against Buddhist anātman, it is not release without an enduring self-substance. Yet critics ask how an intrinsically perfect soul could be beginninglessly obscured and how material karma affects consciousness. Jainism answers that the jīva-karma relation is anādi but terminable and that embodied jīva has pradeśas through which karma associates with it. These replies preserve internal coherence but leave an interaction puzzle.

Therefore the quotation is accurate. Jaina mokṣa preserves substantial identity while transforming every karmically conditioned mode. Purification and transformation are not rivals: the former explains continuity, the latter the radical difference between saṃsārin and siddha.

Why this earns marks

- Interprets the quotation through the central dravya-paryāya distinction.
- Reconstructs the complete bondage-and-release mechanism.
- Integrates ratnatraya, vows, eight karmas and guṇasthānas.
- Distinguishes sayoga-kevalī, ayoga-kevalī and siddha.
- Uses Advaita and Buddhism for controlled comparison.
- Ends with a synthesis that preserves both continuity and transformation.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Can Jaina pluralistic realism consistently sustain both epistemic humility and the claim to omniscience? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Establish the realist and pluralist ontology.
- Derive epistemic humility from finite cognition and standpoint theory.
- Test the compatibility and evidential burden of kevala-jñāna.
- Reach a graded verdict rather than dismissing either side.

Full answer

Jainism is pluralistic because it accepts infinitely many jīvas and five irreducible kinds of ajīva; it is realistic because dravyas, guṇas and paryāyas exist independently of cognition. Reality itself is **ananta-dharmātmaka**, possessed of indefinitely many aspects. Anekāntavāda is therefore ontological complexity, not subjective construction.

Epistemic humility follows from the condition of the ordinary knower. Mati and śruta depend on senses, mind, signs and karmic limitation. Such cognition apprehends an aspect rather than the whole. Nayavāda legitimises partial standpoints while warning against their absolutisation; syādvāda makes assertions conditional; saptabhaṅgī systematises affirmation, negation and inexpressibility. Humility is thus disciplined realism: one may know truly without knowing exhaustively.

At first, omniscience seems to threaten this architecture. If no assertion exhausts reality, how can a kevalin know all aspects? If Jainism invokes kevala-jñāna to guarantee the truth of its system, the doctrine may become circular. A Cārvāka or modern empiricist will add that unlimited cognition lacks public verification.

The Jaina answer distinguishes finite discursivity from the intrinsic cognitive power of the purified soul. Mati and śruta are mediated; avadhi and manaḥparyāya show degrees of unmediated cognition; kevala-jñāna is complete

manifestation after knowledge-obscuring karma is destroyed. Non-absolutism is therefore not the claim that exhaustive knowledge is impossible in principle. It is the claim that finite, karmically conditioned standpoints must not masquerade as such knowledge.

This reply has three strengths. First, it prevents humility from collapsing into scepticism: standpoints track objective aspects. Second, it gives soteriology an epistemic goal: purification enlarges cognition. Third, it allows the doctrine to explain its own possibility-comprehensive teaching ultimately rests on kevalin knowledge.

However, these strengths create burdens. The graded series from sensory cognition to omniscience does not by itself prove that the final term exists. Reflexively qualifying *anekāntavāda* preserves consistency but may weaken its universal authority. Further, if *kevala-jñāna* is non-discursive, its communication through language again enters partial standpoint-forms. The omniscient content may be complete while every transmitted proposition remains conditioned.

The most coherent interpretation therefore separates ontological, cognitive and linguistic levels. Reality is objectively many-sided; ordinary cognition is partial; *kevala-jñāna* is postulated as comprehensive; linguistic communication remains selective even when sourced in comprehensive cognition. On this reading, humility and omniscience are logically compatible but not evidentially equal.

Jainism can consistently sustain both claims because they concern different epistemic conditions. Yet consistency is not proof: omniscience remains the system's strongest internal culmination and its greatest external evidential vulnerability.

Why this earns marks

- Establishes pluralism and realism before turning to epistemology.
- Derives humility through *matī/śruta*, *nayavāda*, *syādvāda* and *saptabhaṅgī*.
- States the circularity and verification objections in strong form.
- Gives the graded-knowledge and karmic-obstruction reply.
- Adds the sophisticated distinction between complete cognition and selective communication.
- Delivers a graded verdict separating logical compatibility from evidential proof.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Layer-placement note

All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice. It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced synthesis

The cross-sectarian standing of the *Tattvārthasūtra* supplies a common doctrinal grammar without erasing Śvetāmbara-Digambara differences. This matters methodologically: cite the text as a shared systematic anchor, but do not infer complete uniformity of canon or practice. Tīrthaṅkaras are perfected teachers rather than creators, so Jaina religious authority remains compatible with an uncreated cosmos.

The deeper philosophical architecture is reciprocal. Metaphysical many-sidedness explains epistemic partiality; epistemic discipline supports ethical non-violence in thought; ethical purification removes the karmic obstruction that prevents complete knowledge. Treating these as unrelated chapters misses the system's unity.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections, replies and comparisons

Contradiction objection: how can permanence and change belong to one real? The Jaina reply indexes them to different ontological dimensions: permanence belongs to substance, while origination and decay belong to modes. This anticipates the broader strategy of standpoint qualification.

Buddhist challenge: an enduring substrate may appear unnecessary if causal continuity explains identity. Jainism replies that change is intelligible as the change of something and that a real bearer better explains responsibility and liberation.

Advaita challenge: plurality may be only empirical appearance. Jainism treats difference, matter and individual souls as ultimately real; liberation does not dissolve numerical individuality.

Nyāya challenge: *dharma-dravya* and *adharma-dravya* look unparsimonious. The Jaina defence treats them as enabling media, not forces or moral properties. The hardest remaining burden is the interaction of conscious *jīva* with material *pudgala*.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced evaluation

The Jaina inversion of ordinary terminology is a frequent source of error: strict *pratyakṣa* is independent of senses and mind, whereas ordinary sensory cognition is conventionally direct but philosophically mediated. This scheme supports non-absolutism because finite embodied knowledge is partial, not because objects are unreal.

The strongest external difficulty concerns higher cognition and omniscience. These states organise the system's account of complete truth, but they are difficult to verify from an ordinary standpoint. A second difficulty is circularity: complete knowledge validates the many-sided system, while the system explains why complete knowledge exists. The Jaina reply appeals to graded removal of obscuring karma, but the evidential burden remains.

Do not equate epistemic humility with universal scepticism. A standpoint is assessable by whether it captures a real aspect; not every claim is equally valid.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections and replies

Contradiction: "is" and "is not" cannot both be true. The Jaina reply is that they are never asserted in the same respect, relation, place and time. Qualification preserves rather than violates non-contradiction.

Redundancy: why exactly seven forms? They systematically combine affirmation, negation and inexpressibility without repeating a logical possibility.

Self-refutation: if all claims are conditional, is *anekāntavāda* itself merely conditional? The strongest Jaina reply distinguishes the minimal unconditional insight that finite unqualified predication is incomplete from an exhaustive absolutist description of reality.

The omniscience cost: *kevala-jñāna* prevents the system from becoming total relativism, but its independent proof remains difficult. Thus Jainism is better classified as qualified or non-absolutist realism, not relativism in the sense that every opinion is equally true.

LINK: **2026 conceptual anchor:** recent public and educational discussions around Mahāvīra Jayanti again used *anekāntavāda* as a resource for dialogue amid polarization. This is an application analogy only, not evidence for the classical doctrine.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections, replies and ethical refinements

The distinctive strength of Jaina karma theory is its integration of psychology, ethics and embodiment: *bhāvabandha* explains inner adhesiveness, while *dravyabandha* explains objective karmic continuity. Its deepest metaphysical weakness is interaction: how does material *pudgala* bind an intrinsically conscious soul?

Beginningless bondage avoids the need for a first moral fall, but creates another question: if the soul is naturally perfect, why is obscuration beginningless? Jainism answers operationally rather than historically-liberation requires removing present causes and accumulated matter.

The fourteen *guṇasthānas* make liberation gradual and technically ordered. The *sayoga-kevalī* stage is important because omniscience can occur while minimal embodied activity remains; final disembodied liberation follows later.

Sallekhanā must be analysed by intention, conditions and passionlessness. In its ideal doctrinal form it is a disciplined thinning of attachment at life's appropriate end, not impulsive self-destruction. Contemporary legal or medical claims require separate case-specific verification.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced dialectical verdict

Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja press the law of non-contradiction: a real cannot possess opposed attributes. The Jaina reply succeeds where predicates are explicitly indexed, but it still must explain the universal status of its own many-sided ontology.

Buddhist criticism challenges the permanent-yet-changing soul. Jainism gains moral agency and numerical continuity, while Buddhism gains ontological economy. Neither side wins without choosing a criterion-continuity, parsimony or explanatory adequacy.

Nyāya's interaction and extension objections expose a genuine pressure point. The lamp-light analogy makes bodily co-extension intelligible, but does not fully explain material karma's contact with consciousness.

Cārvāka's evidential challenge is strongest against higher cognition and liberation. Jaina internal coherence is not by itself external verification. The defensible final classification is **pluralistic, realistic and non-absolutist**, with acknowledged burdens concerning omniscience, soul-matter interaction and reflexive qualification.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced synthesis

The safest overall verdict is **qualified realism**. Jainism is realist because substances, souls, matter and modes exist independently of our descriptions. It is pluralist because no single substance or consciousness absorbs the rest. It is non-absolutist because finite predication captures aspects rather than the exhaustive whole.

Its achievement is architectural: permanence and change, truth and humility, agency and embodiment, ethics and liberation are integrated in one system. Its costs are equally systematic: taxonomy can become heavy; omniscience is difficult to verify; karmic matter creates an interaction problem; and the doctrine must reserve enough unconditional truth to state its own non-absolutism.

The final answer should never conclude "all viewpoints are true". The stronger conclusion is that viewpoints are conditionally valid when they track objective aspects and become false when absolutised.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

A. System identity

- Printed syllabus: theory of reality; *saptabhaṅgīnaya*; bondage and liberation.
- Shared textual anchor: Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī's *Tattvārthasūtra*.
- Non-creator framework; Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers.
- Path: right vision, right knowledge and right conduct.

B. Reality

- *Sat* possesses *utpāda*, *vyaya* and *dhrauvya*.
- Substance persists while modes originate and cease.
- Six *dravyas*: *jīva*, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa and kāla.
- Five are *astikāyas*; time is a dravya but not an *astikāya*.

C. Substance and soul

- Every dravya has abiding *guṇas* and changing *pariyāyas*.
- Many *jīvas* are real, beginningless and intrinsically conscious.
- Pudgala includes bodies, sense objects and karmic matter.
- Dharma/adharma are media of motion/rest, not merit/demerit.

D. Knowledge

- Strict Jaina *pratyakṣa* is unmediated soul-direct knowledge.
- Mati and śruta are mediated; avadhi, manaḥparyāya and kevala are strictly direct.
- Ordinary cognition is karmically partial.
- Kevala-jñāna is complete, unobstructed knowledge.

E. Many-sided judgement

- *Anekānta*: objective many-sidedness.
- *Naya*: legitimate partial standpoint.
- *Syāt*: “in some respect,” preventing absolutisation.
- Partial truth becomes error when presented as exhaustive.

F. Sevenfold predication

1. somehow it is;
2. somehow it is not;
3. somehow it is and is not;
4. somehow it is inexpressible;
5. somehow it is and is inexpressible;
6. somehow it is not and is inexpressible;
7. somehow it is, is not and is inexpressible.

Opposites are indexed to substance, place, time and mode; *avaktavya* is not mere ignorance.

G. Absolutism objection

- Critic: universal non-absolutism seems self-defeating.
- Reply: objective many-sidedness grounds conditional finite claims.
- Omniscience supplies a complete standpoint within the system.
- Residual burden: justify omniscience and the doctrine’s own universal reach.

H. Karma and bondage

- Karma is subtle material *pudgala*.
- Activity brings influx; passion fixes and intensifies it.
- Bhāvabandha is psychic bondage; dravyabandha is material adhesion.
- Four parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.

I. Liberation sequence

ĀSRAVA → BANDHA → SAṃVARA → NIRJARĀ → MOKṢA

- Saṃvara stops new karma; nirjarā removes old karma.
- Liberation is subtraction of obstruction, not merger or annihilation.
- The siddha remains an individual omniscient soul.

J. Ethics and stages

- Five vows: ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya and aparigraha.
- Seven tattvas become nine padārthas by adding puṇya and pāpa.
- Eight karma types divide into ghātiyā and aghātiyā.
- Fourteen *guṇasthānas* culminate in sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī.

K. Criticism-reply grid

Critic	Pressure	Jaina reply
Śaṃkara/Rāmānuja	contradiction	different respects and modes
Buddhist	permanence plus change	dravya persists; paryāya changes
Nyāya	soul-matter interaction	jīva has pradeśas; karmic matter is subtle
Empiricist	omniscience unverifiable	inference, testimony and system coherence

L. Final answer discipline

1. Identify the exact syllabus limb.
2. Define terms before listing classifications.
3. Link reality to judgement or karma to liberation.
4. Preserve ordered sequences exactly.
5. State one named objection and the Jaina reply.
6. Distinguish internal coherence from external proof.
7. Conclude with qualified realism, not “all views are true.”

Final judgement: Jainism achieves a powerful integration of permanence and change, realism and humility, and ethics and liberation; its hardest costs are the material soul-karma interaction and the epistemic burden of omniscience.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the panels as one topic-specific conceptual atlas: root question, classifications, processes or arguments, comparisons, objections and a final answer-writing spine. This text-native master is separate from both graphical flowchart artifacts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/8: Jainism: central question and analytical axes

JAINISM – CONCEPTUAL ATLAS

KEY TERMS: Jainism • jīva • ajīva • anekāntavāda • karma • triratna

CENTRAL QUESTION / ROOT

How should the complete structure of Jainism be defined, related, compared and evaluated?

Jain philosophy combines pluralistic realism, anekāntavāda...

AXIS 1: JAIN FRAMEWORK, SOURCES AND SOTERIOLOGICAL AIM

- Jainism
- Jīva becomes bound when passions attract karmic matter, while...

AXIS 2: PRAMĀṆA, KNOWLEDGE AND ANEKĀNTAVĀDA

- Pramāṇa
- In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the...

AXIS 3: SEVEN TATTVAS, NINE PADĀRTHAS AND KARMA-PRAKṚTIS

- Seven Tattvas
- The seven tattvas (real categories for liberation-analysis) are...

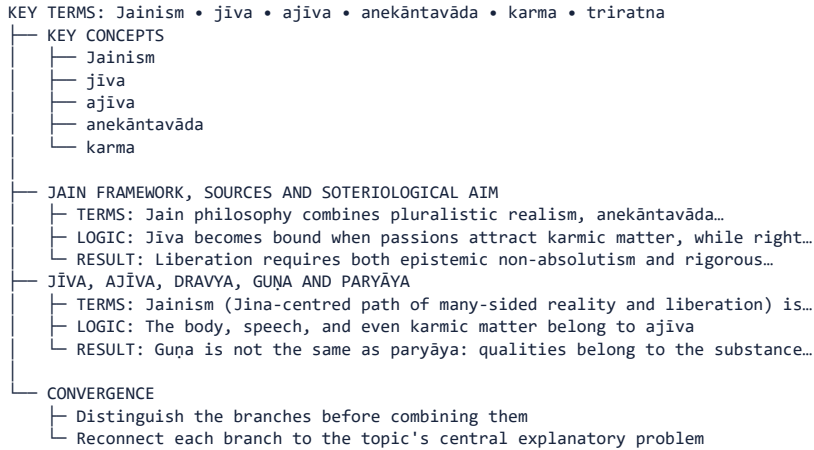
CROSS-PANEL CONTROL

Jainism • jīva • ajīva • anekāntavāda

Definition → relation → mechanism → comparison → verdict

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/8: Jiva-ajiva ontology, substance, quality and modes

JIVA-AJIVA ONTOLOGY, SUBSTANCE, QUALITY AND MODES

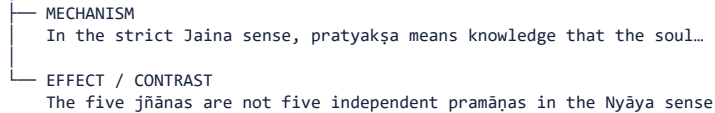


ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/8: Knowledge, anekantavada, nayavada and syadvada logic

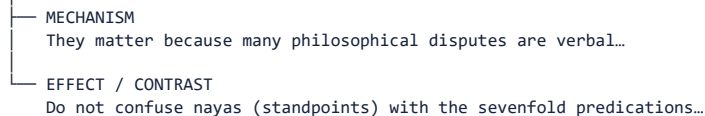
KNOWLEDGE, ANEKANTAVADA, NAYAVADA AND SYADVADA LOGIC

KEY TERMS: Pramāṇa • Knowledge • Anekāntavāda • pratyakṣa • parokṣa • sāmvyavahārika
KEY TERMS: pratyakṣa

CAUSE / CONDITION 1: In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the...



CAUSE / CONDITION 2: Nayavāda teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a...



SYSTEM RESULT: causes interact; mechanism explains why the outcome follows.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/8: Karmic bondage, triratna and the liberation mechanism

KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND THE LIBERATION MECHANISM

KEY TERMS: Karmic Bondage • Triratna • Liberation • pudgala • material • āsrava - bandha -
KEY TERMS: saṃvara - nirjarā...

MODEL / BRANCH	CORE POSITION	DISTINCTION / RESULT
KARMIC BONDAGE, TRIRATNA AND LIBERATION	Anger or greed in the soul is bhāvabandha	Unlike Buddhist nirvāṇa, it is liberation of a distinct enduring...

COMPARE ON THE SAME AXIS: definition • mechanism • consequence • limit

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/8: Tattvas, karma types, gunasthanas and sallekhana

TATTVAS, KARMA TYPES, GUNASTHANAS AND SALLEKHANA

KEY TERMS: Seven Tattvas • Nine Padārthas • Karma-Prakṛtis • tattvas • jīva • ajīva
CLAIM / SYSTEM UNDER EXAMINATION

PROBLEM / OBJECTION 1

- ISSUE: The jīva-karma relation is anādi (beginningless) but not endless
- RESPONSE / CONTROL: The seven tattvas (real categories for
- RESPONSE / CONTROL: liberation-analysis) are...
- QUALIFIED VERDICT: Jaina mokṣa is not acquisition of God's grace, not merger
- QUALIFIED VERDICT: into...

PROBLEM / OBJECTION 2

- ISSUE: A lamp with its obscuring cover removed shines fully even before...
- RESPONSE / CONTROL: Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta
- RESPONSE / CONTROL: (suicide): suicide...
- QUALIFIED VERDICT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision

FINAL CONTROL: preserve the strongest insight while stating its limit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/8: Inter-school comparisons, objections and Jain replies

INTER-SCHOOL COMPARISONS, OBJECTIONS AND JAIN REPLIES

KEY TERMS: Jain realism • Buddhist momentariness • Advaita non-dualism • Cārvāka materialism
KEY TERMS: • anekāntavāda • jīva

CAUSE / CONDITION 1: Jainism combines enduring substances with changing modes...

- MECHANISM
The comparison turns on whether reality contains enduring...
- EFFECT / CONTRAST
Jainism preserves plurality and persistence while explaining change...

CAUSE / CONDITION 2: Jainism replies through utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya: origination...

- MECHANISM
Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints
- EFFECT / CONTRAST
The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same dravya...

SYSTEM RESULT: causes interact; mechanism explains why the outcome follows.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/8: Jainism: traps, PYQ routes and applied recall

JAINISM: TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND APPLIED RECALL

KEY TERMS: Jainism • jīva • ajīva • anekāntavāda • karma • triratna
EXAM APPLICATION ROOT

- CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS
 - Do not reduce anekāntavāda to relativism, because Jainism affirms a...
 - In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of knowledge with...
 - The jīva-karma relation is anādi (beginningless) but not endless
 - The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the...
- PYQ / QUESTION ROUTES
 - 2018 • Q6(c) • 15 marks
 - Explain the mechanism of bondage, not merely define karma
 - Compare the bound and liberated soul on identity, embodiment, cognition and...
 - "Discuss" requires one conceptual difficulty and a balanced conclusion
- ANSWER USE
 - Jainism links ontology, epistemology and ethics: reality has many...
 - When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs
 - Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: dravya...

CONTROL: identify demand → select exact evidence → expose trap → qualify.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/8: Jainism: integrated revision and answer-writing spine

JAINISM – ANSWER / REVISION SPINE

KEY TERMS: Jainism • jīva • ajīva • anekāntavāda • karma • triratna

1. DEFINE THE PRECISE TOPIC / TERM

└ Jain philosophy combines pluralistic realism, anekāntavāda...



2. MAP THE MAIN TYPES, STAGES OR INSTITUTIONS

└ Jainism



3. EXPLAIN THE MECHANISM / ARGUMENT / CAUSAL LINK

└ They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal...



4. COMPARE ON A COMMON ANALYTICAL AXIS

└ ajīva



5. TEST WITH OBJECTION, LIMIT, EXCEPTION OR TRAP

└ The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the...



6. GIVE A QUALIFIED, TOPIC-SPECIFIC VERDICT

└ Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: dravya...

HIGH-YIELD FORMULA

ROOT CONCEPT

+ CLASSIFICATION / SEQUENCE

+ MECHANISM / EVIDENCE

+ COMPARISON / APPLICATION

+ OBJECTION / LIMIT

= QUALIFIED ANSWER